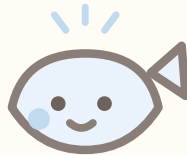




A PRINTABLE STUDY JOURNAL

8 WEEKS OF ENGLISH

B1-B2 · PASSIVE ENGLISH → ACTIVE ENGLISH



NAME

START DATE

END DATE

USE ENGLISH. DON'T JUST STUDY ENGLISH.



How to use this workbook

CORE • 30–40 min

Finish the CORE tasks and the day is done. Nothing is missing, nothing is owed. Every day has four of them.

BONUS • 10–20 min

Extra practice for days you have time and energy. Skipping every bonus for eight weeks still works.

The four phases

- 1–2 Activate** — wake up the English you have.
- 3–4 Express** — longer answers, opinions, stories.
- 5–6 Think in English** — translate less.
- 7–8 Fluency** — speak under real pressure.

Your week: 12 pages

Week page · grammar cheat sheet
 Mon speak · Tue listen · Wed read
 Thu speaking day · Fri grammar
 Sat sound · Sun review
 Writing page · phrase log · week review

Five rules that make it work

- ☐ Speak out loud every day, even for two minutes. Silent study does not count.
- ☐ Write your own version of every phrase. Borrowed sentences do not stick.
- ☐ Record yourself twice a week and listen back. That is where corrections happen.
- ☐ Finish the sentence even when it is wrong. Fluency first, then accuracy.
- ☐ Miss a day, skip it. Never repeat a day and never restart the week.

How the phrase log works

Phrases only go in the log if you met them for real — in listening, reading, a conversation, or as a word you wanted and could not find. Then you review at **+1, +3, +7 and +14 days**. Tick a box only when you retrieved the phrase **without looking**. Recognising it does not count.

Your AI correction prompt

“Correct my English but keep my meaning and my level. First show my mistakes, then explain the three most important recurring problems, then give me a corrected version. Do not rewrite everything in advanced English.”

Use it on every writing page. AI is optional everywhere in this book.

8 weeks at a glance

WEEK 01

ACTIVATE

Everyday you

Grammar: Present simple vs present continuous · Speaking: 60–90 sec monologue · Writing: 100–150 w, your normal day

WEEK 02

ACTIVATE

People and places

Grammar: Comparing things like a speaker, not a textbook · Speaking: 2 min description · Writing: 120–150 w, a person or place

WEEK 03

EXPRESS

Opinions and preferences

Grammar: Opinion structures and hedging · Speaking: 2–3 min opinion · Writing: 130–180 w, opinion post

WEEK 04

EXPRESS

Stories

Grammar: Narrative tenses, and present perfect vs past simple · Speaking: 3 min story · Writing: 150–180 w, personal story

WEEK 05

THINK

Work and problems

Grammar: Modals for politeness and for guessing · Speaking: problem → solution · Writing: 150–200 w, work message

WEEK 06

THINK

Plans, guesses and what-ifs

Grammar: Future forms and the three conditionals · Speaking: hypotheticals, 3 min · Writing: 170–200 w, what-if scenario

WEEK 07

FLUENCY

Discussing ideas

Grammar: Relative clauses and linking ideas · Speaking: 3–5 min argument · Writing: 180–220 w, argue a position

WEEK 08

FLUENCY

Unscripted

Grammar: Personal error audit — your own grammar, not a syllabus · Speaking: 5+ min unscripted · Writing: 200–250 w, free writing

What you are aiming at on day 56

Speaking — 3–5 minutes on an unfamiliar topic, unprepared.

Repair — missing word? explain around it, don't switch language.

Listening — main ideas and most detail without leaning on subtitles.

Conversation — 5–10 minutes without planning each sentence.

Stories — a past story with chronology a listener can follow.

Writing — 180–250 coherent words, alone, no translator.

This is a functional target, not a CEFR promise. Eight weeks of consistent daily production makes retrieval faster and speech more automatic. It does not certify a level.

BASELINE — RECORD YOURSELF



Do all four tasks today, before you read any other page. **Save every file** in one folder called **DAY 1** and do not listen back to them until week 8. Without this page you will have no way to prove you improved.

A · SPEAKING — 2 minutes, no preparation

FILE NAME

Press record and answer: *“Tell me about yourself, your life right now, and one thing you want to change.”*
Start within five seconds. Do not stop, do not restart, do not delete.

I SPOKE FOR TIMES I STOPPED TIMES I USED MY OWN LANGUAGE

B · STORY — 2 minutes

FILE NAME

Record a story about something that actually happened to you in the last month. Beginning, middle, end.
Past tenses, no notes.

I SPOKE FOR THE TENSE THAT BROKE

D · LISTENING — how much do you catch today?

Search YouTube for **“native English conversation everyday life”**. Play four minutes with no subtitles, no pausing. Then estimate honestly.

I UNDERSTOOD ABOUT % WHAT MADE IT HARD

[illegible]



WEEK 01

ACTIVATE

Everyday you — routines, habits, the life you already
live



THIS WEEK'S ONE PROMISE

You will speak English out loud on all seven days, including the day you
do not feel like it.

GRAMMAR

Present simple vs
present continuous

SPEAKING TARGET

60–90 sec monologue

WRITING

100–150 w, your normal
day

WEEK OF

7 DAYS





Present simple vs present continuous

Present simple = things that are generally true: habits, routines, facts, jobs. Present continuous = happening right now, or a temporary situation around now. Most B1 learners know both forms but pick the wrong one under pressure — that is what today fixes.

THE FORMULA

HABIT: I / you / we / they + verb · he / she / it + verb-s
RIGHT NOW or TEMPORARY: am / is / are + verb-ing

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~I am working in a hospital since 2019.~~

I work in a hospital. (permanent) · I'm working from home this month. (temporary)

HOW IT SOUNDS IN REAL ENGLISH

- I work in logistics, but this week I'm covering for my manager.
- She usually cycles to work. Today she's taking the bus — it's raining.
- We don't normally eat out. We're trying to save money.
- He's always losing his keys. (present continuous + always = it annoys me)
- I'm not sleeping well at the moment.

A • PRACTISE — complete each one

- 1 Every morning I _____ (check) my phone before anything else.
- 2 Right now I _____ (sit) at
- 3 She _____ (not usually / work) on Fridays, but this Friday she
- 4 They _____ (build) a new station near my flat — it
- 5 I _____ (try) to stop

B • FIND THE ERROR — one word is wrong in each

- 1 *I am going to the gym three times a week.*
- 2 *What do you do right now? Are you free?*
- 3 *She is speaking four languages.*

C • MAKE IT YOURS — three sentences about your real life

D • SAY IT WITHOUT THINKING. Cover section C. Say your three sentences out loud from memory, then say three new ones. Repeat until none of them need a pause in the middle. This is the only step that makes the grammar automatic.





Words that work

★ also on your printed page · audio for every example: chanochka.github.io/8-weeks-of-english/words.html?week=1

5 MINUTES, MONDAY · THURSDAY · SUNDAY. Monday: read every line out loud and say your own sentence for three.

Thursday: use three on purpose in your speaking day. Sunday: cover the phrases, read the meanings, retrieve them. Tick a box only when the phrase came out of your mouth in a real sentence.

Phrasal verbs

THE VERBS PEOPLE ACTUALLY USE

☐ sleep in ★	sleep later than usual, on purpose	I sleep in on Sundays — never before ten.
☐ run out of ★	use all of something so none is left	We've run out of coffee again.
☐ catch up on ★	do something you had no time for earlier	Saturday morning is when I catch up on emails.
☐ put off ★	delay something you do not want to do	I keep putting off booking the dentist.
☐ get through ★	manage to finish something long or hard	Coffee is how I get through Monday mornings.
☐ wind down ★	relax after a busy time	I read for twenty minutes to wind down before bed.
☐ nod off	fall asleep without meaning to	I nodded off on the sofa halfway through the film.
☐ fit in	find time for something	I try to fit in a walk at lunchtime.
☐ get round to	finally do something you kept meaning to do	I never get round to ironing.
☐ pop out	leave for a short time	I'm just popping out to the shop — back in ten minutes.
☐ head out	leave, start going somewhere	I usually head out around half seven.
☐ clear out	tidy a space by throwing things away	This weekend I'm finally clearing out the wardrobe.

Idioms

THE ONES YOU WILL REALLY HEAR

☐ a creature of habit ★	someone who does the same things the same way every day	I'm a real creature of habit — same breakfast every morning.
☐ snowed under ★	having far too much work	I'm completely snowed under this week.
☐ call it a day ★	stop working for today	It's nine o'clock. Let's call it a day.
☐ in a rut	stuck in a boring routine	I felt like I was in a rut, so I changed jobs.
☐ on the go	busy and active all the time	I'm on the go from seven till seven.
☐ burn the midnight oil	work or study late at night	I burned the midnight oil before the exam.

Words that go together

LEARN THEM AS ONE PIECE

☐ stick to a routine ★ I'm trying to stick to a routine, even at weekends.	☐ make time for ★ I always make time for a proper breakfast.
☐ a hectic schedule ★ I have a hectic schedule on Tuesdays.	☐ grab a bite ★ Let's grab a bite before the film.
☐ run errands ★ I spend Saturday mornings running errands.	☐ skip breakfast ★ I skip breakfast more often than I should.
☐ have a lie-in I had a lie-in this morning — it was lovely.	☐ have an early night I'm exhausted. I'm going to have an early night.
☐ get some fresh air I need to get some fresh air.	☐ the rush hour I avoid the rush hour if I can.



used to • be used to • get used to

Three look-alikes that B1 speakers mix up all the time. One is about the past, two are about what feels normal.

PAST HABIT, NOT NOW

used to + verb — I used to smoke.

NORMAL FOR ME

be used to + -ing / noun — I'm used to getting up early.

BECOMING NORMAL

get used to + -ing / noun — I'm getting used to the noise.

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~I am used to getting up early.~~

I'm used to getting up early.

How it sounds in real English

- I used to hate mornings. Now I'm used to them.
- It took me months to get used to working from home.
- We didn't use to have a car.
- Every summer we'd go to my gran's.

WORTH KNOWING

Would can replace used to for repeated past actions (We'd go to the lake every Sunday), but not for states: I used to have long hair — never I would have long hair. And used to is only for the past: I usually walk to work, not I use to walk to work.

A • Practise — complete each one

ANSWERS AT THE BACK, PAGE 120

- 1 When I was a kid, I _____ (play) outside every day.
- 2 I've lived next to the station for years, so I _____ (the noise).
- 3 She's slowly _____ (work) nights.
- 4 Did you _____ (have) long hair at school?
- 5 I'm still not _____ (speak) English on the phone.

B • Quick check — this week's word bank

FROM MEMORY FIRST

- 1 We've _____ milk. Can you buy some on the way home?
- 2 I keep _____ my tax return. I really need to do it.
- 3 It's late and we're all tired. Let's _____.
- 4 On Sundays I _____ until ten.
- 5 I'm _____ this week — three deadlines and a trip.
- 6 I try to _____ a routine, even when I'm travelling.

C • Say it out loud

RECORD ONE ON THURSDAY

- ☐ Describe your weekday using three phrasal verbs from this page. 60 seconds.
- ☐ What did you use to do every day five years ago that you don't do now?
- ☐ What was hard to get used to in your current job or home?



1 I usually get up around...

2 The first thing I do is...

3 After that I tend to...

4 By the end of the day I'm...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Read the four phrases out loud twice each, then write your own version on the line under each one.
- ☐ Say your four sentences out loud without looking at the page.
- ☐ Talk for 60 seconds about your whole day. Do not stop, do not restart.
- ☐ Write the one word you were missing at the bottom of the page, then look it up.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Record the 60 seconds and listen back once. Write down one thing you would change.
- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “Ask me five simple questions about my daily routine. Wait for my full answer before the next question.”

Four sentences using today's phrases. Real details, real times.



TODAY'S GOAL Catch how people describe ordinary days in unscripted speech.

♥ **LISTEN FOR THESE — TICK EACH ONE YOU HEAR, THEN WRITE THE FULL SENTENCE**

1 It depends on the day, but...

2 Most mornings I...

3 I'm not really a morning person.

4 I try to... but it doesn't always happen.

WHAT TO FIND “native English conversation daily routine”

YouTube · Easy English street interviews or BBC Learning English · length: 4–5 min, clear speech

1 listen once, no subtitles

2 never pause

3 write what you understood

4 listen again

5 catch 3–5 chunks

6 now check the transcript

7 what did you miss, and why

8 shadow 20–40 seconds

9 retell it without looking

☆ **CORE**

30–40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Work through steps 1–9 above in order. Steps 1–3 before you touch the subtitles.
- ☐ Write 3–5 chunks you caught into this week's phrase log — whole phrases, not single words.
- ☐ Shadow 20–40 seconds: play, pause, copy the speaker exactly, including the rhythm.
- ☐ Retell what the clip was about out loud, 30 seconds, nothing on screen.

BONUS

10–20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Listen to the same clip once more while doing something else. Notice what you catch now.
- ☐ Find a second clip on the same topic and see whether the same chunks come back.

WHAT I HEARD



Phrases, half-sentences, fillers — anything that sounded natural rather than correct.



♥ TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH

- ① Apparently she...

② What surprised me was...

3 The article says that...

④ In other words...

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Read one short text about daily life — BBC News, a blog post, a Reddit thread. 300–500 words, start to finish, no dictionary on the first pass.
- ☐ Underline five chunks worth keeping. Put them in the phrase log.
- ☐ Close the text. Retell it out loud from memory in three sentences.
- ☐ Retell it again, faster, with no notes at all.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Write the three-sentence retell down and compare it with the original. What did you drop?
- ☐ Read one paragraph out loud at the speed you would speak it.

THREE-SENTENCE RETELL

Beginning, middle, and the part that stayed with you.

SPEAKING DAY



TODAY'S GOAL Speak for 90 seconds on a question you have not seen before.

♥ **TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH**

1 This week has been...

2 The thing is...

3 I keep meaning to...

4 Honestly, I have no idea.

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ DRILL · 30-SECOND ANSWER. Read the question, start within five seconds: "What is a normal Thursday for you?" Answer for 30 seconds.
- ☐ Same question again, 90 seconds this time. Add detail rather than repeating yourself.
- ☐ Use at least three of this week's phrases on purpose while you speak.
- ☐ When you get stuck, describe the idea another way. Never switch language mid-sentence.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: "Have a 10-minute B1-B2 conversation with me about everyday routines. Do not correct every mistake. At the end tell me my three most frequent mistakes, three expressions I could have used, and one pronunciation issue."
- ☐ Say the hardest sentence of the day three more times, slowly, until it comes out whole.

WHERE I GOT STUCK



Write the sentences you could not finish — then finish them here, properly.



♥ TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH

- 1 I work... / I'm working...
- 2 I always... / I'm currently...
- 3 She lives... / She's staying...
- 4 We usually... / We're trying...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Go back to this week's cheat sheet. Do sections A and B if you have not yet.
- ☐ Section C: write three sentences about your real life, each one using both forms.
- ☐ Section D: cover the page and say them out loud. Then say three brand-new ones.
- ☐ Say each pair fast, one after the other, until neither of them needs a pause.

10-20 MIN • OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +3 DAYS: cover Monday's phrases and retrieve them from memory. Tick the +3 boxes.
- ☐ Write five more pairs, then delete the page. The point was saying them.

Real facts about your real life. No textbook people.

SOUND NATURAL



TODAY'S GOAL Fix where the stress falls in your sentences.

♥ **SAY THESE — THE CAPITALS ARE WHERE THE BEAT LANDS**

1 I usually get UP around SEVEN.

2 The FIRST thing I DO is...

3 It DEPENDS on the DAY.

4 I'm NOT really a MORNING person.

RECOGNISE ONLY — don't copy these

kinda, wanna, gonna — you will hear these constantly.

You do not need to say them.

Understanding them is the whole job today.

PRACTISE SAYING — aim for this

I WORK in a hospital. (not: i work IN a hospital)

It DEPENDS on the day.

Content words loud, small words quick and quiet.

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Find a native version of each sentence: search the phrase on YouGlish, or ask ChatGPT Voice "Say this sentence naturally three times: slow, normal, conversational."
- ☐ LISTEN → COPY → RECORD → COMPARE. Do all four for each sentence.
- ☐ Say each one inside a longer sentence about today.
- ☐ Pick the one sound or beat that gave you away and drill it ten times.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Record 30 seconds of Monday's monologue again and listen for the rhythm, not the words.
- ☐ Read one paragraph out loud, tapping the table on every stressed word.

SOUND NOTES



What your mouth had to do differently. Be physical about it.

REVIEW + RESET



TODAY'S GOAL Prove to yourself that week one actually happened.

♥ TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH

1 This week I managed to...

.....

2 What I found difficult was...

.....

3 Next week I want to...

.....

4 I'm starting to...

.....

☆ CORE

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Review · +7 DAYS: cover the phrase log, retrieve every chunk out loud, tick only what came without looking.
- ☐ Choose the five phrases you must use out loud next week. Write them in the log footer.
- ☐ Speak for two minutes about your week. In English, alone, no notes.
- ☐ Fill in the week review page: the seven numbers, honestly.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Colour in this week on the 56-day poster and set out next week's pages.
- ☐ Write 60 words about the best moment of the week. No corrections.

WEEK ONE, OUT LOUD



Write down the two-minute summary you just said. Not a better version — the one you said.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

I usually...

I tend to...

At the moment I'm...

By the time I...

What I like about it is...

- ☐ verb tense
- ☐ prepositions
- ☐ repeated vocabulary
- ☐ articles
- ☐ sentence linking
- ☐ unnatural translation

"Correct my English but keep my meaning and my level. First show my mistakes, then explain the three most important recurring problems, then give me a corrected version. Do not rewrite everything in advanced English."

SAY EACH ONE OUT LOUD TOO



Only phrases you actually met — in listening, reading, a conversation, or a word you wanted and could not find.
Whole chunks, not single words. Tick a review box only when you retrieved it **without looking at the page**.

HOW TO REVIEW — pick one, never just re-read

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

HOW TO REVIEW — pick one, never just re-read

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

FIVE I MUST USE OUT LOUD NEXT WEEK

.....	
.....	
.....	

FIVE I MUST USE OUT LOUD NEXT WEEK

COMING BACK THIS WEEK · nothing yet — this is week one — find those pages, cover the English, and retrieve five of them out loud before Sunday.

WEEK REVIEW



DAYS I SHOWED UP — COLOUR ONE FLOWER PER DAY



MON



TUE



WED



THU



FRI



SAT



SUN

MEASURE IT — the same seven numbers every week

Longest no-stop speaking min sec Active phrases I actually used

Translating in my head ☐ constantly ☐ often ☐ sometimes ☐ rarely

Listening without subtitles % Confidence speaking 1 2 3 4 5

Grammar mistake I keep making

Hardest sound or rhythm feature

Something I said easily

.....

.....

.....

Where I got stuck

.....

.....

.....

Five things I can say now that I could not say on Monday

1

2

3

4

5

Next week I will change one thing

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

CARRY FORWARD

Copy your five phrases onto next Monday's page. If you did not use last week's five, they come with you again.



WEEK 02

ACTIVATE

People and places — describing what is around you



THIS WEEK'S ONE PROMISE

You will describe things without pointing, without your phone, and without your first language.

GRAMMAR

Comparing things like a speaker, not a textbook

SPEAKING TARGET

2 min description

WRITING

120–150 w, a person or place

WEEK OF

7 DAYS





Comparing things like a speaker, not a textbook

B1 learners compare correctly but flatly: bigger, better, more expensive. B2 speakers add degree — how much bigger. That single move makes descriptions sound alive, and it is the difference today.

THE FORMULA

a bit / slightly / much / far / a lot +
comparative + than nowhere near as +
adjective + as by far the + superlative

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~My town is more quiet than London and the most cheap.~~

My town is much quieter than London — and by far the cheapest place I've lived.

HOW IT SOUNDS IN REAL ENGLISH

- It's a lot quieter than my old street.
- Nowhere near as busy as people think.
- She's by far the most patient person in the team.
- Slightly more expensive, but far better.
- It's not as far as it looks on the map.

A • PRACTISE — complete each one

- 1 My flat is _____ (much / small) than my parents' house. _____
- 2 This café is nowhere near _____
- 3 He's _____ (by far) person I know. _____
- 4 It's _____ (slightly) than last year, but _____
- 5 Winter here is _____ than _____

B • FIND THE ERROR — one word is wrong in each

- 1 *It is more cheaper than the city centre.* _____
- 2 *She is the most nice person in my office.* _____
- 3 *My street is not so busy as before.* _____

C • MAKE IT YOURS — three sentences about your real life

D • SAY IT WITHOUT THINKING. Cover section C. Say your three sentences out loud from memory, then say three new ones. Repeat until none of them need a pause in the middle. This is the only step that makes the grammar automatic.





Words that work

★ also on your printed page · audio for every example: chanochka.github.io/8-weeks-of-english/words.html?week=2

5 MINUTES, MONDAY · THURSDAY · SUNDAY. Monday: read every line out loud and say your own sentence for three.

Thursday: use three on purpose in your speaking day. Sunday: cover the phrases, read the meanings, retrieve them. Tick a box only when the phrase came out of your mouth in a real sentence.

Phrasal verbs

THE VERBS PEOPLE ACTUALLY USE

☐ take after ★	look or behave like an older relative	She takes after her dad — same laugh, same temper.
☐ get on (well) with ★	have a good relationship with	I get on really well with my neighbours.
☐ look up to ★	admire and respect	I've always looked up to my older sister.
☐ put up with ★	accept something annoying	I put up with the noise because the rent is cheap.
☐ show someone around ★	give someone a tour of a place	Let me show you around the old town.
☐ do up ★	repair and decorate an old building	They're doing up the old station.
☐ settle in	start to feel at home in a new place	It took me a few months to settle in.
☐ move out	leave the place where you live	I moved out of my parents' place at twenty.
☐ stand out	be easy to notice	The red church really stands out.
☐ fall out (with)	argue and stop being friends	We fell out over something really stupid.
☐ grow apart	slowly become less close	We grew apart after school.
☐ turn into	change and become something else	The area has turned into a tourist trap.

Idioms

THE ONES YOU WILL REALLY HEAR

☐ in the middle of nowhere ★	far from towns and people	They live in the middle of nowhere — the nearest shop is ten kilometres away.
☐ down-to-earth ★	practical, friendly and not arrogant	She's really down-to-earth for someone so successful.
☐ off the beaten track ★	away from the places tourists usually go	The best cafés are off the beaten track.
☐ a stone's throw from	very close to	My flat is a stone's throw from the station.
☐ like chalk and cheese	completely different (two people)	My brother and I are like chalk and cheese.
☐ go the extra mile	do more than people expect	She always goes the extra mile for her friends.

Words that go together

LEARN THEM AS ONE PIECE

☐ within walking distance ★ Everything I need is within walking distance.	☐ packed with tourists ★ In summer the old town is packed with tourists.
☐ a laid-back atmosphere ★ The café has a really laid-back atmosphere.	☐ a close-knit community ★ It's a close-knit community — everyone knows everyone.
☐ a great sense of humour ★ He has a great sense of humour.	☐ make a good first impression ★ She made a really good first impression.
☐ brehtaking views The flat has breathtaking views of the river.	☐ a strong personality My grandmother had a very strong personality.
☐ a run-down area It used to be a run-down area, but it's changed a lot.	☐ well worth a visit The market is well worth a visit.



The passive for places and things

When you describe a place, who did it is usually unknown or unimportant. The passive puts the place first.

FACTS NOW

is / are + past participle — It's known for its bridges.

HISTORY

was / were + past participle — It was built in 1850.

CHANGES

has been / is being + past participle — It's been turned into flats.

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~The castle was build in 1300. My town is locate near the sea.~~

The castle was built in 1300. My town is located near the sea.

How it sounds in real English

- The old cinema has been turned into a gym.
- Most of the cafés here are run by families.
- The station is being renovated, so use the side entrance.
- It was designed by a famous architect.

WORTH KNOWING

Add by + person only when the person matters: It was designed by Gaudí. Otherwise leave it out — nobody needs to hear that the road was repaired by some workers.

A • Practise — complete each one

ANSWERS AT THE BACK, PAGE 120

- 1 The cathedral _____ (build) in the 14th century.
- 2 Our street _____ (currently / repair).
- 3 The town _____ (know) for its wine.
- 4 The old factory _____ (turn) into a market last year.
- 5 Since 2020 the park _____ (completely / redesign).

B • Quick check — this week's word bank

FROM MEMORY FIRST

- 1 Everyone says I _____ my mum. We even walk the same way.
- 2 The flat is tiny, but I _____ it because the location is perfect.
- 3 My office is _____ from here — about two minutes on foot.
- 4 The museum is _____ from the station — you don't need a taxi.
- 5 They're _____ the old house — new windows, new kitchen.
- 6 He's very _____. He never shows off.

C • Say it out loud

RECORD ONE ON THURSDAY

- ☐ Describe a relative you take after — or don't. 60 seconds.
- ☐ Give a spoken tour of your area with two passives: what it's known for and what was built when.
- ☐ Describe a place off the beaten track that you love.



1 He comes across as...

2 She's the kind of person who...

3 What I like about him is...

4 He can be a bit...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Write your own version of each phrase, about a real person.
- ☐ Describe two people out loud, 60 seconds each: one you love, one who annoys you.
- ☐ DRILL · PARAPHRASE. Describe each person's job without naming it. Make the listener guess.
- ☐ Use last week's five carried-forward phrases at least once between the two descriptions.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Describe a third person in 30 seconds only. Cutting is the exercise.
- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “I’ll describe someone I know. Ask me five follow-up questions to build a fuller picture.”

Be specific. “Nice” and “friendly” tell a reader nothing.



TODAY'S GOAL Hear how people describe places without listing facts.

♥ **LISTEN FOR THESE — TICK EACH ONE YOU HEAR, THEN WRITE THE FULL SENTENCE**

1 It's quite a lively area.

.....

2 There's not much going on.

.....

3 It's known for...

.....

4 You'd like it — it's very...

.....

WHAT TO FIND “walking tour English describing neighbourhood”

YouTube · Easy English, walking tours, or a travel vlogger speaking naturally · length: 5–6 min, normal speed

1 listen once, no subtitles

2 never pause

3 write what you understood

4 listen again

5 catch 3–5 chunks

6 now check the transcript

7 what did you miss, and why

8 shadow 20–40 seconds

9 retell it without looking

☆ **CORE**

30–40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Steps 1–9 above. This week the clip is a minute longer and slightly faster.
- ☐ Collect 5 chunks that describe atmosphere rather than facts. Into the phrase log.
- ☐ Shadow 30 seconds. Match the pauses, not just the words.
- ☐ Retell the clip out loud in 45 seconds without looking.

BONUS

10–20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Listen again at 1.1x speed. Note what you lose.
- ☐ Review · +1 DAY: retrieve yesterday's chunks out loud and tick the +1 boxes.

PLACE PHRASES



Everything you heard about what a place feels like, not what it contains.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....



1 The writer describes it as...

2 To give you an idea...

3 It reminded me of...

4 Picture a...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Read one description of a place: a travel piece, a hotel review, a city subreddit. 400–600 words.
- ☐ Underline five chunks. Log them. Do not log single adjectives.
- ☐ Retell it once with the text in front of you, once with it face down.
- ☐ Now describe a place YOU know using three chunks you just stole.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Rewrite the opening paragraph in your own words, half the length.
- ☐ Read the best paragraph out loud twice.

Same place, your vocabulary. Nothing copied word for word.



① I've lived here for...

② The best thing about it is...

③ What it really needs is...

4 It's a five-minute walk from...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ DRILL · EXPAND IT. Describe your home in one sentence. Then 30 seconds. Then two minutes.
- ☐ Stand up and give a spoken tour of the room you are in, out loud, walking around it.
- ☐ Use three degree comparisons from the cheat sheet while you speak.
- ☐ Record the two-minute version. Do not re-record it.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “I’ll describe my neighbourhood. Then ask me to compare it with a place you invent. Keep it conversational.”
- ☐ Listen back and count the times you stopped. Write the number down.

Write the tour you gave, plus the words you were missing while giving it.



① It's a lot quieter than...

② Nowhere near as busy as...

③ By far the best...

④ Slightly more expensive than...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Cheat sheet sections A and B if you have not done them yet.
- ☐ Section C: three comparisons between two places you know well.
- ☐ Section D: cover the page, say them, then say three new ones about people.
- ☐ Push past “bigger” and “better” — every sentence needs a degree word.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +3 DAYS: retrieve Monday and Tuesday's chunks. Tick the +3 boxes.
- ☐ Compare this week with last week out loud, five sentences.

Two real places or two real people. Degree word in every sentence.

SOUND NATURAL



TODAY'S GOAL Move the stress and change the meaning on purpose.

♥ **SAY THESE — THE CAPITALS CARRY THE MEANING**

1 It's not **THAT** far.

2 I said a **LITTLE** bit.

3 **THIS** is the one I meant.

4 It **WAS** good — once.

RECOGNISE ONLY — don't copy these

a lotta, sorta, dunno — hear them, do not build habits on them.

Fast speech eats small words. That is normal.

Your job is to decode, not to imitate.

PRACTISE SAYING — aim for this

It's not **THAT** far.

I said a **LITTLE** bit.

THIS is the one I meant.

Same words, four meanings.

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Say each sentence twice, moving the stress to a different word. Hear the meaning change.
- ☐ Check yourself against real speakers: search each phrase on YouGlish.
- ☐ LISTEN → COPY → RECORD → COMPARE for all four.
- ☐ Say your two favourite ones inside a description of your street.

BONUS

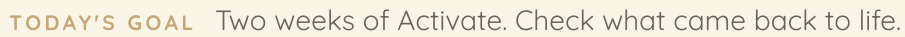
10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Take one sentence and record five versions, each stressing a different word.
- ☐ Ask ChatGPT Voice: "Say this sentence stressing a different word each time and tell me what each version means."

SOUND NOTES



Which word carried the meaning in each version, and why.



① I've noticed that...

② It's getting easier to...

3 I still can't...

4 From now on I'll...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Review · +7 DAYS on this week's log, and +14 DAYS on week 1's log. Retrieve, do not re-read.
- ☐ Choose five phrases for next week. Any of week 1's five you never used come with you again.
- ☐ Speak for two minutes comparing week one with week two.
- ☐ Fill in the week review page. Compare the seven numbers with last week's.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Colour in the poster. Look at the two rows side by side.
- ☐ Write 80 words on the English you had forgotten you knew.

English you had forgotten you knew. List it — this is the whole point of Activate.



Only phrases you actually met — in listening, reading, a conversation, or a word you wanted and could not find.
Whole chunks, not single words. Tick a review box only when you retrieved it **without looking at the page**.

HOW TO REVIEW — pick one, never just re-read

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

HOW TO REVIEW — pick one, never just re-read

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

FIVE I MUST USE OUT LOUD NEXT WEEK

FIVE I MUST USE OUT LOUD NEXT WEEK

COMING BACK THIS WEEK · week 1 phrases — find those pages, cover the English, and retrieve five of them out loud before Sunday.



MON



TUE



WED



THU



FRI



SAT



SUN

Hardest sound or rhythm feature

Copy your five phrases onto next Monday's page. If you did not use last week's five, they come with you again.



WEEK 03

EXPRESS

Opinions and preferences — saying what you actually think



THIS WEEK'S ONE PROMISE

Every opinion you give this week arrives with a reason attached, in the same breath.

GRAMMAR

Opinion structures and hedging

SPEAKING TARGET

2–3 min opinion

WRITING

130–180 w, opinion post

WEEK OF

7 DAYS





Opinion structures and hedging

A flat “I think it’s good” closes a conversation. Real opinions come with a frame (how sure you are) and a reason. Hedging is not weakness — it is what lets you disagree without a fight, and it buys you thinking time.

THE FORMULA

STRONG: I’m convinced that... · There’s no question that... **NEUTRAL:** I’d say... · It seems to me that... · I find it... **SOFT:** I’m not entirely convinced... · I could be wrong, but...

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~I am agree with you. I think is a good idea because is cheap.~~

I agree with you — I’d say it’s a good idea, mainly because it’s cheap.

HOW IT SOUNDS IN REAL ENGLISH

- I’d say it comes down to money, really.
- It seems to me that nobody actually asked the users.
- I’m not entirely convinced that’s the reason.
- I find it hard to believe they didn’t know.
- To be fair, they didn’t have much time.

A • PRACTISE — complete each one

- 1 I’d say the main problem is _____, mainly because _____
- 2 It seems to me that people _____
- 3 I’m not entirely convinced _____ because _____
- 4 I find it hard to _____ that _____
- 5 For me it comes down to _____

B • FIND THE ERROR — one word is wrong in each

- 1 *I am agree with your opinion.* _____
- 2 *In my opinion, I think it is too expensive.* _____
- 3 *I am not agree because is not useful.* _____

C • MAKE IT YOURS — three sentences about your real life

D • SAY IT WITHOUT THINKING. Cover section C. Say your three sentences out loud from memory, then say three new ones. Repeat until none of them need a pause in the middle. This is the only step that makes the grammar automatic.





Words that work

★ also on your printed page · audio for every example: chanochka.github.io/8-weeks-of-english/words.html?week=3

5 MINUTES, MONDAY · THURSDAY · SUNDAY. Monday: read every line out loud and say your own sentence for three.

Thursday: use three on purpose in your speaking day. Sunday: cover the phrases, read the meanings, retrieve them. Tick a box only when the phrase came out of your mouth in a real sentence.

Phrasal verbs

THE VERBS PEOPLE ACTUALLY USE

☐ go along with ★	accept or agree, often without being sure	I went along with the plan, but I wasn't happy about it.
☐ come round (to) ★	change your mind and agree	She'll come round to the idea eventually.
☐ back up ★	support with facts or examples	Can you back that up with an example?
☐ point out ★	tell someone a fact they had not noticed	He pointed out that it would cost twice as much.
☐ stand up for ★	defend a person or an idea	You have to stand up for what you believe in.
☐ rule out ★	decide something is not possible	I wouldn't rule it out completely.
☐ talk someone into	persuade someone to do something	She talked me into buying the expensive one.
☐ come up with	think of an idea or a plan	Who came up with this rule?
☐ be into	like, be interested in (informal)	I'm really into true-crime podcasts.
☐ go off	stop liking something	I've gone off coffee lately.
☐ side with	support one person in an argument	My mum always sides with my brother.
☐ brush off	refuse to take something seriously	He just brushed off my suggestion.

Idioms

THE ONES YOU WILL REALLY HEAR

☐ sit on the fence ★	avoid choosing a side	Stop sitting on the fence — which one do you prefer?
☐ not my cup of tea ★	not something I like	Jazz isn't really my cup of tea.
☐ see eye to eye ★	agree completely	We don't always see eye to eye on money.
☐ have mixed feelings	feel both positive and negative	I have mixed feelings about working from home.
☐ play devil's advocate	argue the other side to test an idea	Let me play devil's advocate for a second.
☐ a matter of taste	it depends on what each person likes	Whether it's beautiful is a matter of taste.

Words that go together

LEARN THEM AS ONE PIECE

☐ have strong views on ★ My dad has strong views on everything.	☐ a valid point ★ That's a valid point, but I still disagree.
☐ change your mind ★ What would make you change your mind?	☐ a controversial topic ★ Tourism is a controversial topic in my city.
☐ make a case for ★ She made a good case for a four-day week.	☐ a heated discussion ★ We had a heated discussion about it at dinner.
☐ strongly disagree I strongly disagree with that.	☐ a fair point Fair point — I hadn't thought of that.
☐ take something seriously Nobody took my idea seriously.	☐ from my point of view From my point of view, it's a waste of money.

Verb + -ing or verb + to



After some verbs English wants -ing, after others to. There is no logic you can feel — you learn the common ones as chunks.

+ -ING

enjoy · mind · avoid · can't stand · keep · feel like · suggest

+ TO

want · decide · refuse · tend · hope · seem · would like

NO TO

I'd rather + verb · let / make someone + verb

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~I enjoy to cook. I suggest you to go. I'd rather to stay.~~

I enjoy cooking. I suggest going. I'd rather stay.

How it sounds in real English

- I can't stand waiting in queues.
- I tend to avoid arguing about politics.
- I don't feel like going out tonight.
- They refused to give us a refund.

WORTH KNOWING

After a preposition it is always -ing: I'm thinking of leaving · I'm interested in learning · instead of complaining. And some verbs change meaning: I stopped to buy coffee (I stopped walking in order to buy it) · I stopped buying coffee (I don't buy it any more).

A · Practise — complete each one

ANSWERS AT THE BACK, PAGE 120

- 1 I don't mind _____ (work) late if I have to.
- 2 They refused _____ (change) the rule.
- 3 I'd rather _____ (walk) than take the bus.
- 4 She keeps _____ (tell) me it's fine.
- 5 I'm thinking of _____ (quit) the gym.

B · Quick check — this week's word bank

FROM MEMORY FIRST

- 1 I didn't want to go, but my friend _____ me _____ it.
- 2 Horror films are not _____. I prefer comedies.
- 3 He _____ that we had forgotten to count the tax.
- 4 You can't agree with both of us — stop _____!
- 5 At first she hated the plan, but she _____ in the end.
- 6 That's _____, but I still think it's too expensive.

C · Say it out loud

RECORD ONE ON THURSDAY

- ☐ Give your opinion on remote work with one idiom and two -ing verbs (I can't stand..., I enjoy...). 60 seconds.
- ☐ Play devil's advocate: defend something you actually dislike.
- ☐ Tell the story of a time someone talked you into something.



1 Personally, I'd say...

2 The reason I say that is...

3 I'd rather... than...

4 For me it comes down to...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Pick three topics: your city's transport, remote work, one rule at your job. Write nothing yet.
- ☐ For each one, speak the pattern out loud: OPINION → REASON → EXAMPLE. About 40 seconds each.
- ☐ Now write your best of the three, three sentences only.
- ☐ DRILL · REPAIR IT. Say it again; when you make a mistake, correct it and carry on without restarting.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Add a fourth topic you have no opinion about. Invent one anyway and defend it.
- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “Give me a B1–B2 opinion question. After my answer, ask why. Do not accept a one-sentence reason.”

Opinion, reason, example. Three times. Reasons must be specific.



TODAY'S GOAL Hear exactly how people soften and strengthen what they think.

♥ **LISTEN FOR THESE — TICK EACH ONE YOU HEAR, THEN WRITE THE FULL SENTENCE**

1 I'm not entirely convinced.

.....

2 To be fair...

.....

3 I completely agree with...

.....

4 That's a good point, but...

.....

WHAT TO FIND “two people discussing opinions English podcast”

YouTube or a podcast app · TED-Ed comments, interviews, discussion podcasts · length: 6–7 min, two speakers

1 listen once, no subtitles

2 never pause

3 write what you understood

4 listen again

5 catch 3–5 chunks

6 now check the transcript

7 what did you miss, and why

8 shadow 20–40 seconds

9 retell it without looking

☆ **CORE**

30–40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Steps 1–9 above. Two speakers this week, so track who thinks what.
- ☐ Collect 5 chunks used to agree, disagree or hedge. Log them.
- ☐ Sort them: which sounded strong, which sounded careful? Write S or C next to each.
- ☐ Shadow 30 seconds of the more careful speaker.

BONUS

10–20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +1 DAY on yesterday's chunks.
- ☐ Listen once more and note every time someone disagreed without saying “no”.

AGREE / DISAGREE



Everything you heard, sorted by how strong it felt.



① The main argument is...

② On the other hand...

3 I can see why, but...

④ Where I disagree is...

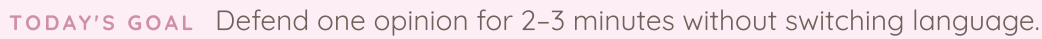
30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Read one opinion piece — a newspaper column, a long comment, a blog post. 500–700 words.
- ☐ Summarise the writer’s argument out loud in three sentences, fairly.
- ☐ Now argue the opposite side out loud for 60 seconds, whether you believe it or not.
- ☐ Log five chunks. Include at least two that link ideas.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Write two sentences the writer would use against you.
- ☐ Read the strongest paragraph out loud as if you had written it.

Their argument on top, yours underneath. Be fair to theirs first.



① Let me put it another way.

② What I'm trying to say is...

③ Take my job, for example.

④ I could be wrong, but...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Pick something you genuinely dislike. Speak for two minutes on why.
- ☐ Same topic again, three minutes, adding one concession: "To be fair..."
- ☐ DRILL · ONE-MINUTE NO-STOP. New topic, no prep, keep going even when the grammar slips.
- ☐ Use three of this week's carried-forward phrases while you talk.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “Pretend you disagree with my opinion. Have a natural debate with me for five minutes. Push back, but stay friendly.”
- ☐ Record the three-minute version and count your silent pauses.

Write your strongest version — after saying it out loud, never before.



① I find it hard to believe that...

② I'd say it's more about...

③ It seems to me that...

④ I don't see the point of...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Cheat sheet A and B. Pay attention to the “I am agree” trap — it is the most common B1 error in this area.
- ☐ Section C: three opinions about your own field or city.
- ☐ Section D: cover the page, say them, then say three new ones with a softer frame.
- ☐ Say each opinion twice: once strong, once hedged. Notice which one you would actually use.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +3 DAYS on this week's chunks.
- ☐ Take one opinion and write it three ways: strong, neutral, soft.

Strong opinions only — weak ones teach you nothing.

SOUND NATURAL



TODAY'S GOAL Make disagreement sound friendly rather than cold.

♥ **SAY THESE — TWICE EACH: ONCE WARM, ONCE COLD**

1 Hmm, I'm not sure about that.

2 Really? I'd have said...

3 Yeah, no, exactly.

4 Well, it depends.

RECOGNISE ONLY — don't copy these

Yeah, no, exactly — sounds contradictory, means “I agree”.

Rising tone on a statement = checking, not asking.
You will hear all of this. Decoding it is enough.

PRACTISE SAYING — aim for this

Hmm, I'm not sure about that. (fall, then warm up)
Really? I'd have said... (genuine rise)
Well, it depends. (slow, no edge)

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Say each one warmly, then coldly. Record both. Keep only the warm version.
- ☐ Check against real speakers on YouGlish, or ask ChatGPT Voice for a natural version.
- ☐ LISTEN → COPY → RECORD → COMPARE.
- ☐ Write down what physically changed: pitch, speed, or where you paused.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Disagree with three statements out loud, all warmly.
- ☐ Play the cold versions to yourself. That is what a bad day sounds like in English.

SOUND NOTES



Pitch, speed, pause — which one did the work?



① I've changed my mind about...

2 I still think...

③ What I couldn't explain was...

④ This week taught me...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Review · +7 DAYS on this week, +14 DAYS on week 2. Retrieve out loud, tick only what came clean.
- ☐ Choose five phrases for next week.
- ☐ Speak for 2-3 minutes on the opinion you defended best this week.
- ☐ Fill in the week review page and compare the numbers with week 1.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Colour in the poster.
- ☐ Write 100 words on an opinion you changed this week.

The opinion you would now happily say to a stranger.

An opinion post

Personally, I'd say...

The reason I say that is...

To be fair...

That said...

For me it comes down to...

- ☐ verb tense
- ☐ prepositions
- ☐ repeated vocabulary
- ☐ articles
- ☐ sentence linking
- ☐ unnatural translation

"Correct my English but keep my meaning and my level. First show my mistakes, then explain the three most important recurring problems, then give me a corrected version. Do not rewrite everything in advanced English."

SAY EACH ONE OUT LOUD TOO



Only phrases you actually met — in listening, reading, a conversation, or a word you wanted and could not find.
Whole chunks, not single words. Tick a review box only when you retrieved it **without looking at the page**.

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

COMING BACK THIS WEEK · weeks 1-2 phrases — find those pages, cover the English, and retrieve five of them out loud before Sunday.



MON



TUE



WED



THU



FRI



SAT



SUN

Hardest sound or rhythm feature

Copy your five phrases onto next Monday's page. If you did not use last week's five, they come with you again.



WEEK 04

EXPRESS

Stories — telling what happened without falling apart



THIS WEEK'S ONE PROMISE

You will tell one story out loud every day, and every day it gets shorter and clearer.

GRAMMAR

Narrative tenses, and
present perfect vs past
simple

SPEAKING TARGET

3 min story

WRITING

150–180 w, personal
story

WEEK OF

7 DAYS





Narrative tenses, and present perfect vs past simple

Stories need three tenses working together: past simple for the events, past continuous for the background, past perfect for what happened before. Separately: use past simple when the time is finished (yesterday, last week), present perfect when it is not (this week, ever, so far).

THE FORMULA

BACKGROUND: was / were + verb-ing
EVENTS: past simple
EARLIER THAN THAT: had + past participle
FINISHED TIME → past simple
UNFINISHED TIME → have / has + participle

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~I have seen him yesterday. When I arrived, he already left.~~

I saw him yesterday. When I arrived, he had already left.

HOW IT SOUNDS IN REAL ENGLISH

- I was walking home when my phone died.
- By the time we got there, they'd already eaten.
- I've been to Berlin three times. I went last March.
- While we were waiting, someone took our table.
- I hadn't realised how late it was.

A • PRACTISE — complete each one

- 1 I _____ (wait) at the station when I _____ (see) _____
- 2 By the time I arrived, she _____ (already / leave). _____
- 3 I _____ (never / try) sushi before I _____
- 4 We _____ (live) here for three years. Before that we _____
- 5 I _____ (lose) my keys yesterday, so I _____

B • FIND THE ERROR — one word is wrong in each

- 1 *I have finished my work two hours ago.* _____
- 2 *When I was arriving, the meeting started already.* _____
- 3 *I am here since Monday.* _____

C • MAKE IT YOURS — three sentences about your real life

D • SAY IT WITHOUT THINKING. Cover section C. Say your three sentences out loud from memory, then say three new ones. Repeat until none of them need a pause in the middle. This is the only step that makes the grammar automatic.



Words that work



★ also on your printed page · audio for every example: chanochka.github.io/8-weeks-of-english/words.html?week=4

5 MINUTES, MONDAY · THURSDAY · SUNDAY. Monday: read every line out loud and say your own sentence for three.

Thursday: use three on purpose in your speaking day. Sunday: cover the phrases, read the meanings, retrieve them. Tick a box only when the phrase came out of your mouth in a real sentence.

Phrasal verbs

THE VERBS PEOPLE ACTUALLY USE

☐ end up ★	finally be somewhere or do something you did not plan	We ended up sleeping at the airport.
☐ set off ★	start a journey	We set off at five to beat the traffic.
☐ break down ★	stop working (a car, a machine)	The car broke down in the middle of nowhere.
☐ run into ★	meet someone by chance	Guess who I ran into at the station?
☐ get away with ★	do something wrong and not be punished	He was late every day and somehow got away with it.
☐ make up ★	invent a story or an excuse	I made up an excuse and left early.
☐ find out	discover a fact	I found out later that she'd known all along.
☐ show up	arrive, often late or unexpectedly	He showed up two hours late with no explanation.
☐ carry on	continue	We just carried on as if nothing had happened.
☐ work out	understand, solve	It took me ages to work out what had happened.
☐ burst into (tears / laughter)	suddenly start crying or laughing	When she saw the cake, she burst into tears.
☐ calm down	become less upset	It took me an hour to calm down.

Idioms

THE ONES YOU WILL REALLY HEAR

☐ out of the blue ★	suddenly and unexpectedly	Out of the blue, he called me after ten years.
☐ a blessing in disguise ★	something bad that turns out to be good	Missing that train was a blessing in disguise.
☐ my heart sank ★	I suddenly felt sad or worried	When I saw the queue, my heart sank.
☐ in the nick of time	only just in time	We got to the gate in the nick of time.
☐ the last straw	the final problem that makes you lose patience	When the bus didn't come, that was the last straw.
☐ once in a blue moon	very rarely	I only see him once in a blue moon.

Words that go together

LEARN THEM AS ONE PIECE

☐ lose track of time ★ We were talking and completely lost track of time.	☐ a last-minute change of plan ★ There was a last-minute change of plan.
☐ get completely lost ★ We got completely lost on the way back.	☐ by pure chance ★ We met by pure chance at a friend's wedding.
☐ a narrow escape ★ Nobody was hurt — it was a narrow escape.	☐ miss the last train ★ We missed the last train and had to walk.
☐ for the first time in ages I went dancing for the first time in ages.	☐ pouring with rain It was pouring with rain and I had no umbrella.
☐ a close call The car stopped just in time. That was a close call.	☐ an unexpected turn of events Then there was an unexpected turn of events.



Reported speech — telling what people said

Every story has other people's words in it. B2 speakers report them instead of acting out every line.

SAY / TELL

She said (that) she was tired · He told me (that) he'd missed the train.

ONE STEP BACK

is → was · has done → had done · will → would · can → could

QUESTIONS

asked if / asked where + normal word order: She asked where I lived.

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~He said me that he was late. She asked me where do I live.~~

He told me he was late. She asked me where I lived.

How it sounds in real English

- My boss told me to take the day off.
- He asked if I'd seen his keys.
- She asked me not to tell anyone.
- They said they'd call back, but they never did.

WORTH KNOWING

Requests: told me to / asked me not to + verb. If something is still true, you don't have to move the tense back: She said she lives in Kyiv. In casual stories people often switch to the present to make it vivid: So he goes, "Are you serious?"

A · Practise — complete each one

ANSWERS AT THE BACK, PAGE 120

- 1 "I'm leaving." → She said she _____ leaving.
- 2 "Can you help me?" → He asked _____ I could help him.
- 3 "Don't be late." → She told me _____ be late.
- 4 "Where do you work?" → He asked me where _____.
- 5 "I've never been there." → She said she _____ never been there.

B · Quick check — this week's word bank

FROM MEMORY FIRST

- 1 We wanted a quiet night in, but we _____ dancing until three.
- 2 I _____ my old teacher at the supermarket yesterday.
- 3 Losing that job was _____ — I found a much better one.
- 4 We were chatting and _____ — suddenly it was midnight.
- 5 Halfway up the mountain the bus _____.
- 6 She called me completely _____ after five years of silence.

C · Say it out loud

RECORD ONE ON THURSDAY

- ☐ Tell a story that ended differently than planned. Use end up, find out and one idiom.
- ☐ Report a real conversation from this week: what did someone say, tell you or ask you?
- ☐ Talk about a close call you had. 90 seconds.



1 So this happened last...

2 At first I thought...

3 And then, out of nowhere...

4 In the end it turned out...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Choose a real story. Write only four words on the page — the four beats, nothing else.
- ☐ Tell it out loud from the four words. Two minutes.
- ☐ Tell it again in half the time. Cut everything that is not the point.
- ☐ Write the short version down, using all four of today's phrases.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Tell the same story to a real person and watch where they lose interest.
- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “I’ll tell you a story. Interrupt me with questions a real listener would ask.”

The version that keeps the point and drops the rest.



TODAY'S GOAL Notice the small phrases that hold a story together.

♥ **LISTEN FOR THESE — TICK EACH ONE YOU HEAR, THEN WRITE THE FULL SENTENCE**

1 You're not going to believe this.

.....

2 Long story short...

.....

3 Anyway, so...

.....

4 The funny thing is...

.....

WHAT TO FIND “storytelling podcast English real story”

Podcast app or YouTube · storytelling shows, interviews, stand-up sets · length: 7–8 min, natural pace

1 listen once, no subtitles

2 never pause

3 write what you understood

4 listen again

5 catch 3–5 chunks

6 now check the transcript

7 what did you miss, and why

8 shadow 20–40 seconds

9 retell it without looking

☆ **CORE**

30–40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Steps 1–9 above. Do not read the transcript before step 6, however tempting.
- ☐ Collect 5 chunks that moved the story forward rather than described anything.
- ☐ Mark every point where the speaker jumped back in time. How did they signal it?
- ☐ Retell the story in 60 seconds, out loud, nothing on screen.

BONUS

10–20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +1 DAY on yesterday's chunks.
- ☐ Listen at 1.15x. Storytelling speech is fast — get used to it.

STORY GLUE



The little phrases that hold a story together. Not the content words.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....



💖 TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH

- 1 A friend of mine once...
- 2 Apparently what happened was...
- 3 By the time he...
- 4 That's when...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Read a short true story: a news feature, a Reddit story, a magazine piece. 600–800 words.
- ☐ Retell it out loud in 45 seconds.
- ☐ Retell it again in 20 seconds. Only what someone needs to hear.
- ☐ Log five chunks, including two time expressions.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Write the 20-second version and count the words. Under 60?
- ☐ Tell it as if it happened to you. Change the pronouns and see what breaks.

Only what someone actually needs to hear. Nothing else survives.



① The first time I ever...

② I'll never forget...

③ It was one of those days when...

④ Looking back, I should have...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Tell three stories out loud: a good day, a bad day, an embarrassing one. About a minute each.
- ☐ Pick the best one and tell it again for three full minutes without stopping.
- ☐ DRILL · RANDOM TOPIC. Open a book at any page, take the first noun, tell a true story about it. Five seconds to start.
- ☐ Record the three-minute story. Do not re-record.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “Ask me to tell you about a time something went wrong. Then ask three follow-up questions I could not predict.”
- ☐ Listen back and mark every point where the tense slipped.

Which tense broke, and what you said instead. Then write the correct version.



① I was walking home when...

2 I'd already left by the time...

3 While we were waiting...

4 I hadn't realised that...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Cheat sheet A and B. The present perfect / past simple contrast is the part to get right.
- ☐ Section C: three sentences about ONE real event, using all three past tenses.
- ☐ Section D: cover the page and tell that whole event out loud in 45 seconds.
- ☐ Tell it again. Any sentence that needed a pause, say five more like it.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +3 DAYS on this week's chunks.
- ☐ Write five "by the time..." sentences about your real life.

One real event. No invented textbook people.

SOUND NATURAL



TODAY'S GOAL Say -ed endings without adding a syllable.

♥ **SAY THESE — THREE GROUPS, THREE DIFFERENT ENDINGS**

1 walked / worked / asked — /t/

2 lived / opened / arrived — /d/

3 wanted / decided / started — /ɪd/

4 I walked home and called her.

RECOGNISE ONLY — don't copy these

used to → “yoosta” in fast speech.

Whole endings vanish between consonants.

Recognise it. Do not aim for it.

PRACTISE SAYING — aim for this

walked, worked, asked — one syllable, /t/ at the end.

lived, opened, arrived — one syllable, /d/.

wanted, decided, started — two syllables, /ɪd/.

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Say each group out loud five times. Only the third group gets an extra syllable.
- ☐ Check yourself on YouGlish, or ask ChatGPT Voice “Say these six past tense verbs naturally.”
- ☐ Read yesterday's three sentences aloud, checking every single ending.
- ☐ Record 45 seconds of your Thursday story and listen only for the endings.

BONUS

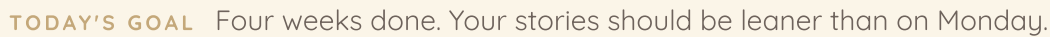
10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Read a paragraph of past-tense text out loud, marking every ending first.
- ☐ Drill the one group your mouth resists, ten times.

SOUND NOTES



Which endings you were adding an extra syllable to — and how it felt to stop.



① I'm halfway through...

② The biggest change so far is...

③ I used to... but now I...

4 For the next four weeks...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Review · +7 DAYS on this week, and pull ten chunks from weeks 1–3 at random. Retrieve them cold.
- ☐ Choose five phrases for next week.
- ☐ Tell your best story of the week to a real person, or to camera.
- ☐ Fill in the week review page. This is the WEEK 4 column on the poster — copy the three numbers across.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Compare your week 1 and week 4 numbers. Write one sentence about what actually moved.
- ☐ Colour in the poster. Half the sheet should have colour on it now.

What is easier now than on day one. Be concrete — no “I feel better”.

In the end it turned out...



Only phrases you actually met — in listening, reading, a conversation, or a word you wanted and could not find.
Whole chunks, not single words. Tick a review box only when you retrieved it **without looking at the page**.

HOW TO REVIEW — pick one, never just re-read

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

HOW TO REVIEW — pick one, never just re-read

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

FIVE I MUST USE OUT LOUD NEXT WEEK

FIVE I MUST USE OUT LOUD NEXT WEEK

COMING BACK THIS WEEK · a sample from weeks 1-3 — find those pages, cover the English, and retrieve five of them out loud before Sunday.



MON



TUE



WED



THU



FRI



SAT



SUN

Hardest sound or rhythm feature

Copy your five phrases onto next Monday's page. If you did not use last week's five, they come with you again.



WEEK 05

THINK IN ENGLISH

Work and problems — explaining, asking, solving



THIS WEEK'S ONE PROMISE

When a word is missing you will explain around it in English, not reach for your own language.

GRAMMAR

Modals for politeness
and for guessing

SPEAKING TARGET

problem → solution

WRITING

150–200 w, work
message

WEEK OF

7 DAYS



Modals for politeness and for guessing



Two jobs, same small words. Politeness: could, would, might make a request or suggestion softer, which is how requests actually sound at work. Speculation: must, might, can't say how sure you are about something you do not know.

THE FORMULA

POLITE: Would it be possible to...? · It might be worth... · Could we...? **SURE:** it must be · **POSSIBLE:** it might / could be · **IMPOSSIBLE:** it can't be

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~You must send me the file today. I think maybe he is ill.~~

Would you be able to send me the file today? · He must be ill — he never misses a Monday.

HOW IT SOUNDS IN REAL ENGLISH

- Would it be possible to move our call to Thursday?
- It might be worth checking with the supplier first.
- That can't be right — we paid it last month.
- She must be exhausted; she's been travelling all week.
- I was wondering whether you'd had a chance to look at it.

A • PRACTISE — complete each one

- 1 Would it be possible to _____ ? (a real request you need to make) _____
- 2 It might be worth _____ before we _____
- 3 That can't be right, because _____
- 4 He _____ (must / be) busy — he _____
- 5 I was wondering whether _____

B • FIND THE ERROR — one word is wrong in each

- 1 *Can you to send me the report, please?* _____
- 2 *Maybe he must be at home now.* _____
- 3 *I would like that you help me.* _____

C • MAKE IT YOURS — three sentences about your real life

D • SAY IT WITHOUT THINKING. Cover section C. Say your three sentences out loud from memory, then say three new ones. Repeat until none of them need a pause in the middle. This is the only step that makes the grammar automatic.





Words that work

★ also on your printed page · audio for every example: chanochka.github.io/8-weeks-of-english/words.html?week=5

5 MINUTES, MONDAY · THURSDAY · SUNDAY. Monday: read every line out loud and say your own sentence for three.

Thursday: use three on purpose in your speaking day. Sunday: cover the phrases, read the meanings, retrieve them. Tick a box only when the phrase came out of your mouth in a real sentence.

Phrasal verbs

THE VERBS PEOPLE ACTUALLY USE

☐ deal with ★	handle a problem or a person	I deal with complaints most of the day.
☐ figure out ★	find the answer or the reason	We still haven't figured out what caused it.
☐ follow up (on) ★	check or act on something later	I'll follow up on this tomorrow morning.
☐ take on ★	accept work or responsibility	I've taken on too much this month.
☐ fall behind ★	not keep up with a plan or schedule	We've fallen behind schedule because of the delays.
☐ run something by someone ★	tell someone an idea to get their opinion	Can I run something by you before the meeting?
☐ sort out	fix, organise	Let's sort it out before Friday.
☐ come up	happen unexpectedly	Something's come up — can we move the call?
☐ back out (of)	decide not to do what you agreed	The client backed out at the last minute.
☐ carry out	do a task, a test, a plan	We carried out a few tests last week.
☐ look into	investigate	I'll look into it and let you know.
☐ set up	arrange, organise	Could you set up a meeting for Monday?

Idioms

THE ONES YOU WILL REALLY HEAR

☐ get the ball rolling ★	start something	Let's get the ball rolling with a quick call.
☐ back to square one ★	back at the start after something failed	The test failed, so we're back to square one.
☐ on the same page ★	agreeing, understanding the same thing	Let's make sure we're all on the same page.
☐ not rocket science	not difficult	Come on, it's not rocket science.
☐ a steep learning curve	a lot to learn quickly	The first month was a steep learning curve.
☐ touch base	contact someone briefly	Let's touch base on Friday.

Words that go together

LEARN THEM AS ONE PIECE

☐ meet a deadline ★ We can't meet the deadline without more people.	☐ tackle a problem ★ We need to tackle the problem, not the symptoms.
☐ raise an issue ★ I'd like to raise an issue about the schedule.	☐ make progress ★ We've made good progress this week.
☐ take responsibility for ★ I take full responsibility for the mistake.	☐ a quick fix ★ There's no quick fix for this.
☐ a tight budget We're working with a very tight budget.	☐ reach an agreement We finally reached an agreement.
☐ a heavy workload I have a heavy workload this month.	☐ run smoothly Everything ran smoothly in the end.



Present perfect continuous — what you've been doing

At work you constantly explain what has been going on up to now. This tense does exactly that, and it is the one B1 speakers avoid.

STILL GOING

have / has been + -ing — I've been working on it since Monday.

JUST STOPPED, RESULT VISIBLE

You look tired. Have you been working late?

HOW LONG vs HOW MANY

been + -ing for time · present perfect for a number: I've sent four emails.

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~I am working on this since Monday. I've been writing three emails.~~

I've been working on this since Monday. I've written three emails.

How it sounds in real English

- We've been having problems with the server all week.
- Sorry I'm late — have you been waiting long?
- I've been trying to reach you all morning.
- They've been working on a fix since yesterday.

WORTH KNOWING

State verbs don't take -ing, even here: I've known him for years, not I've been knowing him. The same goes for have (= own), like, believe, understand, need.

A • Practise — complete each one

ANSWERS AT THE BACK, PAGE 120

- 1 I _____ (try) to call you all morning!
- 2 How long _____ you _____ (work) here?
- 3 I _____ (send) four emails so far.
- 4 You look exhausted. _____ you _____ (sleep) badly?
- 5 We _____ (wait) for their answer since Tuesday.

B • Quick check — this week's word bank

FROM MEMORY FIRST

- 1 We've _____ schedule, so we need two more days.
- 2 Can I _____ an idea _____ you before I send it?
- 3 The new system failed, so we're _____.
- 4 Sorry, something's _____. Can we talk tomorrow?
- 5 I _____ (work) on this report since eight o'clock.
- 6 Honestly, it's _____ — anyone can learn it in a day.

C • Say it out loud

RECORD ONE ON THURSDAY

- ☐ Describe a problem you've been dealing with lately. Use the present perfect continuous at least twice.
- ☐ Explain how you would get the ball rolling on a new project.
- ☐ Tell the story of a plan that went back to square one.



1 Basically, my job is to...

2 I'm responsible for...

3 Day to day, I mostly...

4 The tricky part is...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Explain your work out loud twice: once to a ten-year-old, once to an expert. 30 seconds each.
- ☐ DRILL · PARAPHRASE CHALLENGE. Explain three tools or terms you use daily without naming them.
- ☐ Write your four phrases with real detail from your own job.
- ☐ Say the expert version again, no notes, in under 30 seconds.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “I’ll explain my job. Ask me the three questions a client would ask, then tell me what was unclear.”
 - ☐ Explain the part of your work you find hardest to describe. Twice.

Two versions: the simple one on top, the detailed one underneath.



TODAY'S GOAL Follow a real conversation about a problem, and how people manage it.

♥ **LISTEN FOR THESE — TICK EACH ONE YOU HEAR, THEN WRITE THE FULL SENTENCE**

1 We're running into...

2 The issue is that...

3 Can we circle back to...

4 Just to be clear...

WHAT TO FIND “workplace English conversation solving a problem”

YouTube · business English channels, real meeting recordings, work podcasts · length: 8–9 min, two or more speakers

1 listen once, no subtitles

2 never pause

3 write what you understood

4 listen again

5 catch 3–5 chunks

6 now check the transcript

7 what did you miss, and why

8 shadow 20–40 seconds

9 retell it without looking

☆ **CORE**

30–40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Steps 1–9 above. No subtitles at all until step 6, even if you lose the thread.
- ☐ Collect 5 chunks for managing a conversation: interrupting, checking, buying time.
- ☐ Note who steered the conversation and which phrase they used to do it.
- ☐ Retell the problem and the outcome in 60 seconds.

BONUS

10–20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +1 DAY.
- ☐ Listen again and write the one sentence you would have said in that meeting.

MEETING PHRASES



Phrases for interrupting, checking and buying yourself time.



💖 TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH

- ④ If that doesn't work...

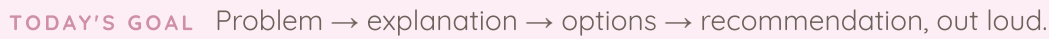
30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Read something instructional in English: a how-to guide, documentation, a troubleshooting thread.
- ☐ Close it. Explain the solution out loud as if training a new colleague.
- ☐ Do it again in half the time, keeping every step.
- ☐ Log five chunks, including two sequencing phrases.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Explain it to someone who does not work in your field and watch where they frown.
- ☐ Write the steps as five short numbered lines.

Steps in order, in your words. Someone should be able to follow them.



1 What I'd suggest is...

2) Have we considered...?

3 The risk there is...

4 Let's say, for argument's sake...

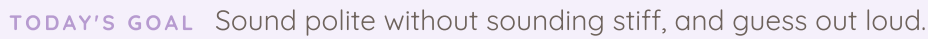
30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Take a real problem you are dealing with. Describe it out loud in 60 seconds.
- ☐ Then three options out loud, each with its risk. Then your recommendation.
- ☐ DRILL · ONE-MINUTE NO-STOP on a problem you have not thought about before.
- ☐ Notice every time you nearly translated. Mark it with a tick in the margin.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “I’ll describe a problem at work. Play a sceptical colleague and challenge my solution for five minutes.”
- ☐ Record the recommendation only, 30 seconds, and make it sound decisive.

Problem at the top, options in the middle, your decision last.



① Would it be possible to...?

② It might be worth...

3 We tend to...

④ I was wondering whether...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Cheat sheet A and B.
- ☐ Section C: take three blunt sentences you would actually say at work and soften them.
- ☐ Section D: cover the page, say all three, then guess out loud about three things you do not know.
- ☐ Say the blunt version and the polite version back to back. Hear the difference.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +3 DAYS.
- ☐ Rewrite a real message you sent last week using two modals.

Direct version on the line, polite version underneath it.

SOUND NATURAL



TODAY'S GOAL Group your words into thoughts, and pause between them.

♥ **SAY THESE — SLOWLY, WITH A REAL PAUSE IN THE MIDDLE**

1 Sorry, could you say that again?

2 Just so I understand...

3 Let me check I've got this right.

4 I'll get back to you on that.

RECOGNISE ONLY — don't copy these

"Would you" often sounds like "wudja".

"what do you" → "whaddaya".

Hear it, decode it, move on.

PRACTISE SAYING — aim for this

Just so I understand / you need it by Friday / not Thursday.

Pause at the slashes. Do not pause anywhere else. Thought groups make you clear. Speed does not.

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Mark the thought groups in each sentence with a slash before you say it.
- ☐ Check a native version on YouGlish, or ask ChatGPT Voice for the natural rhythm.
- ☐ LISTEN → COPY → RECORD → COMPARE. Compare your pauses, not your accent.
- ☐ Record a 60-second voicemail about a real work problem, pausing on purpose.

BONUS

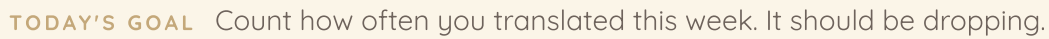
10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Listen back and mark where you sped up. That is where a listener loses you.
- ☐ Say your longest sentence of the week with three deliberate pauses.

SOUND NOTES



Where you sped up, and where a pause would have helped.



① I caught myself translating when...

② It came out automatically.

3 I got stuck on... so I said...

4 Next week I'll practise...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Review · +7 DAYS on this week, +14 DAYS on week 3.
- ☐ Choose five phrases for next week.
- ☐ Speak for two minutes about your work, in English, no notes, no preparation.
- ☐ Fill in the week review page. The translation checkbox is the one that matters this week.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Write 80 words on the moment English arrived first, before your own language.
- ☐ Colour in the poster.

Where the English came first — and where you had to go round the houses.

PHRASE LOG



Only phrases you actually met — in listening, reading, a conversation, or a word you wanted and could not find. Whole chunks, not single words. Tick a review box only when you retrieved it **without looking at the page**.

PHRASE OR CHUNK	WHAT IT MEANS (IN ENGLISH)	MY OWN SENTENCE	+1	+3	+7	+14
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐

HOW TO REVIEW — pick one, never just re-read

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

FIVE I MUST USE OUT LOUD NEXT WEEK

COMING BACK THIS WEEK · weeks 3–4 phrases — find those pages, cover the English, and retrieve five of them out loud before Sunday.



MON



TUE



WED



THU



FRI



SAT



SUN

Hardest sound or rhythm feature

Copy your five phrases onto next Monday's page. If you did not use last week's five, they come with you again.



WEEK 06

THINK IN ENGLISH

Plans, guesses and what-ifs



THIS WEEK'S ONE PROMISE

You will talk about things that have not happened yet without slowing down to build the sentence.

GRAMMAR

Future forms and the three conditionals

SPEAKING TARGET

hypotheticals, 3 min

WRITING

170–200 w, what-if scenario

WEEK OF

7 DAYS



Future forms and the three conditionals



Future: going to for plans already made, will for decisions made as you speak, present continuous for arrangements with a time and place. Conditionals: type 1 is real and likely, type 2 is imaginary now, type 3 is a finished regret.

THE FORMULA

1st: If + present, will... 2nd: If + past, would... 3rd: If + had + participle, would have + participle

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~If I will have time, I would come. If I would know, I told you.~~

If I have time, I'll come. · If I'd known, I would have told you.

HOW IT SOUNDS IN REAL ENGLISH

- If it rains, I'll take the car.
- If I were you, I'd ask for more time.
- If I hadn't moved here, I wouldn't have met her.
- I'm meeting them at six — it's already arranged.
- Unless something changes, we're staying.

A • PRACTISE — complete each one

- 1 If I _____ (finish) early today, I _____
- 2 If I were you, I _____ (not / accept) _____
- 3 If I _____ (not / start) this workbook, I _____
- 4 I _____ (see) the dentist on Tuesday at nine. (arrangement) _____
- 5 Unless _____, I'll _____

B • FIND THE ERROR — one word is wrong in each

- 1 *If I will see him, I will tell him.* _____
- 2 *If I would have known, I would come.* _____
- 3 *I will meet my sister tomorrow at seven, it is arranged.* _____

C • MAKE IT YOURS — three sentences about your real life

D • SAY IT WITHOUT THINKING. Cover section C. Say your three sentences out loud from memory, then say three new ones. Repeat until none of them need a pause in the middle. This is the only step that makes the grammar automatic.





Words that work

★ also on your printed page · audio for every example: chanochka.github.io/8-weeks-of-english/words.html?week=6

5 MINUTES, MONDAY · THURSDAY · SUNDAY. Monday: read every line out loud and say your own sentence for three.

Thursday: use three on purpose in your speaking day. Sunday: cover the phrases, read the meanings, retrieve them. Tick a box only when the phrase came out of your mouth in a real sentence.

Phrasal verbs

THE VERBS PEOPLE ACTUALLY USE

☐ look forward to (+ -ing) ★	feel happy about something that will happen	I'm looking forward to seeing you.
☐ fall through ★	fail to happen (a plan)	Our holiday plans fell through at the last minute.
☐ plan ahead ★	make plans early	I like to plan ahead, at least a month.
☐ go ahead (with) ★	start doing what you planned	We're going ahead with the move in May.
☐ put aside ★	save money or time for later	I put aside a bit every month for travel.
☐ settle down ★	start a calmer life with a home and a routine	I want to travel a bit before I settle down.
☐ call off	cancel	They called off the wedding a week before.
☐ think something over	consider carefully before deciding	Let me think it over and I'll tell you on Monday.
☐ count on	rely on, trust	You can count on me.
☐ pan out	develop, turn out (a situation)	Let's see how things pan out.
☐ bring forward	move to an earlier date	They brought the meeting forward to Monday.
☐ sign up (for)	register for a course or an activity	I've signed up for a pottery class.

Idioms

THE ONES YOU WILL REALLY HEAR

☐ play it by ear ★	decide as things happen, without a plan	I don't have a plan for Saturday — let's play it by ear.
☐ cross that bridge when we come to it ★	deal with a problem only if it happens	What if it rains? We'll cross that bridge when we come to it.
☐ up in the air ★	not decided yet	Our summer plans are still up in the air.
☐ a long shot	unlikely to work, but worth trying	It's a long shot, but I've applied anyway.
☐ keep my options open	avoid deciding too early	I'm keeping my options open for now.
☐ have second thoughts	start to doubt a decision	I'm having second thoughts about the move.

Words that go together

LEARN THEM AS ONE PIECE

☐ a long-term goal ★ My long-term goal is to work abroad.	☐ take a risk ★ Sometimes you have to take a risk.
☐ stand a good chance of ★ You stand a good chance of getting the job.	☐ weigh up the pros and cons ★ I'm still weighing up the pros and cons.
☐ a backup plan ★ Always have a backup plan.	☐ in the near future ★ I'm not planning to move in the near future.
☐ set a goal I set a goal of reading one book a month.	☐ a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity It was a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity.
☐ save up for I'm saving up for a new laptop.	☐ the chances are slim The chances are slim, but it's possible.

I wish • If only



Wish goes one step back in time, just like the second and third conditionals. Once you see that, it stops being scary.

NOW, I WANT IT DIFFERENT

wish + past — I wish I had more time.

PAST, REGRET

wish + past perfect — I wish I'd started earlier.

SOMEONE ELSE, ANNOYANCE

wish + would — I wish he'd stop interrupting.

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~I wish I have more time. I wish I would be taller.~~

I wish I had more time. I wish I was / were taller.

How it sounds in real English

- I wish I could speak without stopping to think.
- If only I'd taken that job.
- I wish it would stop raining.
- I wish I hadn't said that.

WORTH KNOWING

Mixed conditionals join two times. Past cause, present result: If I'd taken that job, I'd be living in Berlin now. Present cause, past result: If I were braver, I'd have said something.

A • Practise — complete each one

ANSWERS AT THE BACK, PAGE 120

- 1 I wish I _____ (live) closer to the sea.
- 2 I wish I _____ (not / say) that yesterday.
- 3 I wish the neighbours _____ (turn down) the music.
- 4 If only I _____ (can) take the day off.
- 5 If I _____ (study) harder at school, I _____ (have) a better job now.

B • Quick check — this week's word bank

FROM MEMORY FIRST

- 1 Our trip _____ because the airline cancelled the flight.
- 2 I'm really _____ the holidays.
- 3 We don't know yet — everything is still _____.
- 4 I wish I _____ (know) about this course last year.
- 5 It's _____, but maybe they'll say yes.
- 6 Before you decide, _____ the pros and cons.

C • Say it out loud

RECORD ONE ON THURSDAY

- ☐ Talk about a plan that fell through and what you did instead.
- ☐ Three wishes out loud: one about now, one about the past, one about another person.
- ☐ What is a long shot you'd like to try in the next year?



① I'm planning to...

② I'm hoping to... by...

③ There's a chance I might...

4 Either way, I'll...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Draw a two-branch tree in the box: one thing that might happen, and what you do in each case.
- ☐ Speak both branches out loud, 60 seconds each, from the tree only.
- ☐ Then describe your next six months in 90 seconds without the tree.
- ☐ Use going to for real plans and will for decisions you make while speaking. Notice which you reach for.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Add a third branch: the outcome you are avoiding thinking about. Speak that one too.
- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “Ask me about my plans, then ask what I’d do if each one fell through.”

Branches on the left, what you would do on the right.



TODAY'S GOAL Hear how people avoid committing to anything about the future.

♥ **LISTEN FOR THESE — TICK EACH ONE YOU HEAR, THEN WRITE THE FULL SENTENCE**

1 It's looking likely that...

.....

2 I doubt it, to be honest.

.....

3 We'll see how it goes.

.....

4 Chances are...

.....

WHAT TO FIND “English discussion predictions future of work”

YouTube · TED talks, interviews, panel discussions · length: 9-10 min, one speaker plus questions

1 listen once, no subtitles

2 never pause

3 write what you understood

4 listen again

5 catch 3-5 chunks

6 now check the transcript

7 what did you miss, and why

8 shadow 20-40 seconds

9 retell it without looking

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Steps 1-9 above. Ten minutes now — split it into two halves if you need to.
- ☐ Collect 5 chunks that say maybe without saying maybe.
- ☐ Mark how sure the speaker was each time: sure, probably, doubtful.
- ☐ Retell their main prediction in 60 seconds, then say whether you believe it.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +1 DAY.
- ☐ Listen at 1.2x. Note whether you lose meaning or just comfort.

MAYBE PHRASES



Ways of saying maybe without saying maybe, sorted by how sure they sound.

.....

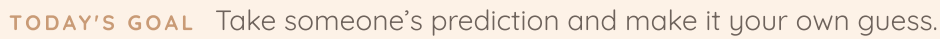
.....

.....

.....

.....

.....



① They're expecting...

② If that happens, then...

③ It could well be that...

④ I wouldn't be surprised if...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Read one article that predicts something in your field or city. 600–800 words.
- ☐ Retell the prediction out loud, fairly, in three sentences.
- ☐ Then say what you actually think will happen, and what you would bet on.
- ☐ Log five chunks, including two that show how sure someone is.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Write two sentences saying why the article might be wrong.
- ☐ Say your prediction as if you were sure, then as if you doubted it.

What you think will happen, and what you would actually bet money on.



♥ TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH

- 1 If I had more time, I'd...
- 2 If I'd known, I would have...
- 3 Suppose I moved to...
- 4 I'd probably end up...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ DRILL · RANDOM TOPIC. “What would you do with a free year?” Five seconds to start, three minutes to talk.
- ☐ Second question, no prep: “What would you change about the last five years?” Two minutes.
- ☐ Use one second conditional and one third conditional in each answer.
- ☐ When a conditional collapses mid-sentence, rebuild it out loud and carry on.

10-20 MIN • OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “Give me an unexpected B1-B2 hypothetical question. Give me five seconds to start. Keep asking follow-ups. Do not let me prepare.”
- ☐ Record the three-minute answer and count the conditionals that came out clean.

The conditional that collapsed. Rebuild it properly here.



① If it rains, I'll...

② If I were you, I'd...

③ If I hadn't..., I wouldn't be...

4 Unless something changes...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Cheat sheet A and B. Watch the “if I will” trap — it never happens in English.
- ☐ Section C: three conditionals about your actual situation, one of each type.
- ☐ Section D: cover the page. Say all three, then three new ones, fully contracted (I’d, wouldn’t).
- ☐ Any conditional that needed a pause in the middle — say five more of that type.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +3 DAYS.
 - ☐ Write five third conditionals about real decisions you regret. Say them out loud once, then move on.

Real decisions, real regrets. Type 1, type 2, type 3.

SOUND NATURAL



TODAY'S GOAL Contractions, because conditionals are impossible without them.

♥ **SAY THESE — EVERY CONTRACTION CLEAN AND AUDIBLE**

1 If I'd known, I would have told you.

2 You'll be fine.

3 I wouldn't worry about it.

4 We hadn't even started.

RECOGNISE ONLY — don't copy these

I'd've, shouldn't've, wouldn't'a — real, but not your target.

Native speakers compress "would have" to almost nothing.

Recognise it in listening. Say the clean version.

PRACTISE SAYING — aim for this

I'd · you'll · wouldn't · hadn't — say all four cleanly.

If I'd known, I would have told you.

Clean contractions, not swallowed ones.

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Say each sentence five times, contracted, at speaking speed.
- ☐ Check the natural version on YouGlish or with ChatGPT Voice.
- ☐ LISTEN → COPY → RECORD → COMPARE.
- ☐ Say yesterday's three conditionals again, fully contracted this time.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Find the contraction your mouth refuses and drill it ten times inside a full sentence.
- ☐ Record 60 seconds of hypothetical speech and count the uncontracted forms.

SOUND NOTES



Which contraction your mouth refused, and what you did about it.



① By the end of this I want to...

② The gap now is...

③ I no longer need to...

4 For the last two weeks...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Review · +7 DAYS on this week, +14 DAYS on week 4.
- ☐ Choose five phrases for next week. Weeks 7–8 are where you use them under pressure.
- ☐ Speak for two and a half minutes about where you will be in a year.
- ☐ Fill in the week review page. Compare the seven numbers with week 1 and week 4.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Reread your week 1 review page. Write one sentence about the difference.
- ☐ Colour in the poster.

What you can do now that week-one you could not. Specifics only.



Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

COMING BACK THIS WEEK · weeks 4-5 phrases — find those pages, cover the English, and retrieve five of them out loud before Sunday.

WEEK REVIEW



DAYS I SHOWED UP — COLOUR ONE FLOWER PER DAY



MON



TUE



WED



THU



FRI



SAT



SUN

MEASURE IT — the same seven numbers every week

Longest no-stop speaking min sec Active phrases I actually used

Translating in my head ☐ constantly ☐ often ☐ sometimes ☐ rarely

Listening without subtitles % Confidence speaking 1 2 3 4 5

Grammar mistake I keep making

Hardest sound or rhythm feature

Something I said easily

.....

.....

.....

Where I got stuck

.....

.....

.....

Five things I can say now that I could not say on Monday

1

2

3

4

5

Next week I will change one thing

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

CARRY FORWARD

Copy your five phrases onto next Monday's page. If you did not use last week's five, they come with you again.



WEEK 07

FLUENCY

Discussing ideas — abstract topics, longer turns



THIS WEEK'S ONE PROMISE

You will speak for at least three minutes on an unprepared topic, every single day.

GRAMMAR

Relative clauses and linking ideas

SPEAKING TARGET

3–5 min argument

WRITING

180–220 w, argue a position

WEEK OF

7 DAYS





Relative clauses and linking ideas

This is what turns short answers into long turns. Relative clauses let you add information without stopping (the man who..., the thing that...). Linkers let you change direction mid-turn instead of ending the sentence and starting again.

THE FORMULA

people → who · things → that / which · places
→ where · possession → whose CONTRAST:
however · whereas · that said EMPHASIS: in fact
· which is why

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~The people which I work with are nice. I like it,
but however it is expensive.~~

**The people I work with are nice. · I like it. That
said, it's expensive.**

HOW IT SOUNDS IN REAL ENGLISH

- The thing that annoys me most is the waiting.
- It's a city where nobody stays long.
- She's the one whose idea it was.
- Whereas in my country, nobody would ask that.
- It's expensive, which is why I stopped going.

A • PRACTISE — complete each one

- 1 The thing that _____ most about my job is _____
- 2 I work with people who _____
- 3 It's a place where _____
- 4 Prices went up. That said, _____
- 5 I stopped doing it, which is why _____

B • FIND THE ERROR — one word is wrong in each

- 1 *The book which I read it last week was great.* _____
- 2 *My friend, that lives in Rome, is coming.* _____
- 3 *It is cheap, but however the quality is bad.* _____

C • MAKE IT YOURS — three sentences about your real life

D • SAY IT WITHOUT THINKING. Cover section C. Say your three sentences out loud from memory, then say three new ones. Repeat until none of them need a pause in the middle. This is the only step that makes the grammar automatic.





Words that work

★ also on your printed page · audio for every example: chanochka.github.io/8-weeks-of-english/words.html?week=7

5 MINUTES, MONDAY · THURSDAY · SUNDAY. Monday: read every line out loud and say your own sentence for three.

Thursday: use three on purpose in your speaking day. Sunday: cover the phrases, read the meanings, retrieve them. Tick a box only when the phrase came out of your mouth in a real sentence.

Phrasal verbs

THE VERBS PEOPLE ACTUALLY USE

☐ bring up ★	start talking about a subject	I didn't want to bring up money at dinner.
☐ boil down to ★	be basically about	In the end it all boils down to money.
☐ get across ★	make people understand an idea	I didn't manage to get my point across.
☐ spell out ★	explain very clearly, in detail	Let me spell it out: we can't afford it.
☐ back down ★	stop defending your position	She refused to back down.
☐ sum up ★	give the main points briefly	To sum up, it's cheaper but slower.
☐ play down	make something seem less important	The company played down the risks.
☐ pick up on	notice something small	I picked up on the fact that he was nervous.
☐ touch on	mention briefly	The article only touched on the costs.
☐ stem from	be caused by	Most arguments stem from bad communication.
☐ give in	stop arguing and accept	After an hour I gave in and said yes.
☐ account for	explain the reason for	That accounts for the delay.

Idioms

THE ONES YOU WILL REALLY HEAR

☐ the elephant in the room ★	an obvious problem nobody talks about	Nobody mentioned the budget — the elephant in the room.
☐ a double-edged sword ★	something with both good and bad effects	Social media is a double-edged sword.
☐ food for thought ★	something worth thinking about	That talk gave me a lot of food for thought.
☐ miss the point	not understand the important part	I think you're missing the point.
☐ hit the nail on the head	describe something exactly right	You've hit the nail on the head.
☐ the tip of the iceberg	a small visible part of a much bigger problem	These complaints are just the tip of the iceberg.

Words that go together

LEARN THEM AS ONE PIECE

☐ raise a question ★ It raises an important question.	☐ draw a conclusion ★ It's too early to draw any conclusions.
☐ a key factor ★ Price is a key factor for most people.	☐ have an impact on ★ Remote work has had a big impact on city centres.
☐ a widespread belief ★ It's a widespread belief, but it isn't true.	☐ strike a balance ★ It's hard to strike a balance between work and life.
☐ reach a consensus We never reached a consensus.	☐ a vicious circle Stress, no sleep, more stress — it's a vicious circle.
☐ in the long run In the long run, it'll save money.	☐ play a role in Luck plays a big role in success.



Emphasis — what..., the thing is..., it's... that

In a discussion you need to point at the important part of your sentence. These frames do it, and they buy you a second to think.

WHAT + CLAUSE + IS

What worries me is the cost.

THE THING / PROBLEM / REASON IS

The problem is (that) nobody asked.

IT'S ... THAT / WHO

It's not the money that bothers me, it's the time.

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~The thing what annoys me is the noise.~~

What annoys me is the noise. / The thing that annoys me is the noise.

How it sounds in real English

- What surprised me most was how cheap it was.
- All I'm saying is that we need more time.
- It was Anna who suggested it, not me.
- The reason I left is that nobody listened.

WORTH KNOWING

Use them sparingly: one emphatic frame per turn sounds confident, three in a row sounds like a speech.

A · Practise — complete each one

ANSWERS AT THE BACK, PAGE 120

- 1 The price worries me. → What worries me _____ the price.
- 2 I need a break. → What I need _____ a break.
- 3 Anna suggested it, not me. → It was Anna _____ suggested it.
- 4 Nobody listens. → The problem is _____ nobody listens.
- 5 I'm only saying it's risky. → All I'm _____ is that it's risky.

B · Quick check — this week's word bank

FROM MEMORY FIRST

- 1 In the end, the whole argument _____ money.
- 2 Nobody talked about the layoffs — it was _____.
- 3 I tried to explain, but I couldn't _____ my point _____.
- 4 It's _____: it saves time but costs more.
- 5 _____ worries me is the timing.
- 6 It's hard to _____ a balance between speed and quality.

C · Say it out loud

RECORD ONE ON THURSDAY

- ☐ Is social media a double-edged sword? Three minutes, with two emphasis frames.
- ☐ Name the elephant in the room in your job or your city, and explain it.
- ☐ Sum up the last article you read in 30 seconds, then say what it boils down to.



① There are two sides to this.

② It largely depends on...

③ To take a step back...

④ The underlying issue is...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Write four abstract topics on scraps of paper: e.g. privacy, ambition, cities, education. Fold them.
- ☐ Pick one blind. Five seconds, then speak for three minutes. Do not stop.
- ☐ Pick a second one. Three minutes again, using two relative clauses on purpose.
- ☐ Note the exact second you first ran out of things to say. That is the number to beat.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Third card, three minutes, arguing the side you disagree with.
- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “Give me an abstract B1–B2 topic. Give me five seconds, then let me talk for three minutes without interrupting.”

Topic on the first line. Notes go here AFTER you spoke, never before.



TODAY'S GOAL Follow people who disagree, and hear how they take the floor.

♥ **LISTEN FOR THESE — TICK EACH ONE YOU HEAR, THEN WRITE THE FULL SENTENCE**

1 I'd push back on that.

.....

2 That's exactly my point.

.....

3 Can I just add one thing?

.....

4 Sorry, go on.

.....

WHAT TO FIND "English debate discussion two people disagreeing"

YouTube or podcasts · panel debates, interview shows, discussion podcasts · length: 10–12 min, several speakers, overlapping

1 listen once, no subtitles

2 never pause

3 write what you understood

4 listen again

5 catch 3–5 chunks

6 now check the transcript

7 what did you miss, and why

8 shadow 20–40 seconds

9 retell it without looking

☆ **CORE**

30–40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Steps 1–9 above. Speakers will talk over each other. Follow the argument, not every word.
- ☐ Collect 5 chunks used to take or hand over the floor.
- ☐ Write down how they interrupted without sounding rude.
- ☐ Retell both sides of the disagreement in 90 seconds.

BONUS

10–20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +1 DAY.
- ☐ Listen once more with the transcript and find the phrase you completely missed.

HOLDING THE FLOOR



How they interrupted without being rude — the exact words.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....



💖 TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH

- 1 The author claims that...
- 2 The evidence for that is thin...
- 3 Where I'd agree is...
- 4 A better question might be...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Read a long-form argument: an opinion column, an essay, a detailed review. 800–1000 words.
- ☐ Summarise their case out loud in three sentences, fairly.
- ☐ Rebut it in 90 seconds, point by point, out loud.
- ☐ Log five chunks, at least three of them linkers.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Write the strongest counter-argument against your own rebuttal.
- ☐ Read your favourite paragraph out loud as if it were a speech.

Their claim, your answer, your example. In that order.



1 Fair enough, but consider...

2 I take your point about...

3 Let's agree to differ.

4 What makes you say that?

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Have a real conversation in English — a person, a language exchange, or ChatGPT Voice. Ten minutes minimum.
- ☐ Disagree with something politely, on purpose, at least twice.
- ☐ DRILL · REPAIR IT. Every time you make a mistake, correct it mid-flow and continue. No restarting.
- ☐ Mark the moment you wanted to switch to your own language, and write what you said instead.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “Debate me for five minutes. Take the opposite side of whatever I say and push back hard but politely.”
- ☐ Record the last three minutes and listen for filled pauses in English.

The moment you nearly switched language. What you said instead.



① That said, I still...

② Whereas in my country...

③ In fact, the opposite is true.

4 Which is why I...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Cheat sheet A and B. The double-subject error (“the book which I read it”) is the one to kill.
- ☐ Section C: three long sentences, each with a relative clause and a linker.
- ☐ Section D: cover the page and say them. Then say three new ones, longer.
- ☐ Any sentence that broke in the middle — say it again slowly, then at speed.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +3 DAYS.
- ☐ Take one short sentence and extend it three times with relative clauses.

Do not let them break in the middle. If one does, rewrite it here.

SOUND NATURAL



TODAY'S GOAL Fill your pauses in English instead of stopping dead.

♥ **SAY THESE — THESE ARE YOUR REPLACEMENTS FOR SILENCE**

1 How can I put this...

2 What's the word...

3 I mean, sort of...

4 Give me a second.

RECOGNISE ONLY — don't copy these

Native speakers pause constantly. Fluency is not speed.

You will hear "um, like, sort of" everywhere.

A filled pause is not a mistake.

PRACTISE SAYING — aim for this

How can I put this...

What's the word...

Give me a second.

Say these instead of going silent.

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Write your own-language fillers on the left of the box, and an English replacement for each on the right.
- ☐ Speak for 90 seconds on any topic. Every pause must be filled in English.
- ☐ Record it. Count the silences and count the fillers.
- ☐ Do it again and beat your own number.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Ask ChatGPT Voice: "Say these four hesitation phrases naturally, then use each one in a sentence."
- ☐ Speak for two minutes with no silences longer than two seconds.

SOUND NOTES



Your fillers in your own language, and their English replacements.



💖 TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH

- 1 The only thing still stopping me is...

② I can now... without thinking.

3 I want to sound less...

④ Final week: I will...

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Review · +7 DAYS on this week, +14 DAYS on week 5.
- ☐ Choose five phrases for the final week.
- ☐ Speak for four minutes on any topic. Do not stop once.
- ☐ Fill in the week review page. Name the one habit you will break next week.

BONUS

10-20 MIN • OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Listen to a recording from week 3 and one from this week. Write down two differences.
- ☐ Colour in the poster — one row left.

WEEK SEVEN, OUT LOUD

The one habit you are going to break in the final week.

PHRASE LOG



Only phrases you actually met — in listening, reading, a conversation, or a word you wanted and could not find. Whole chunks, not single words. Tick a review box only when you retrieved it **without looking at the page**.

PHRASE OR CHUNK	WHAT IT MEANS (IN ENGLISH)	MY OWN SENTENCE	+1	+3	+7	+14
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐
			☐	☐	☐	☐

HOW TO REVIEW — pick one, never just re-read

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

FIVE I MUST USE OUT LOUD NEXT WEEK

COMING BACK THIS WEEK · weeks 5–6 phrases — find those pages, cover the English, and retrieve five of them out loud before Sunday.



MON



TUE



WED



THU



FRI



SAT



SUN

Hardest sound or rhythm feature

Copy your five phrases onto next Monday's page. If you did not use last week's five, they come with you again.



WEEK 08

FLUENCY

Unscripted — real life, real people, no preparation



THIS WEEK'S ONE PROMISE

You will use English with a real person on at least four of these seven days.

GRAMMAR

Personal error audit —
your own grammar,
not a syllabus

SPEAKING TARGET

5+ min unscripted

WRITING

200–250 w, free writing

WEEK OF

7 DAYS





Personal error audit — your own grammar, not a syllabus

You now have eight weeks of recordings and writing, which means evidence. This week you learn no new structures and instead fix the two or three errors that actually recur in your own speech.

THE FORMULA

1 listen to three recordings from weeks 5–7, reread three writing pages 2 write every error you find below, then group them 3 the ones appearing three times or more are your targets all week

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~Guessing which grammar you need.~~

Counting which errors you actually make, then drilling only those.

HOW IT SOUNDS IN REAL ENGLISH

- Patterns worth looking for: articles — a / the / nothing at all
- prepositions — in / on / at, depend on, interested in
- present perfect with a finished time (“I have seen him yesterday”)
- third person -s vanishing under pressure · word order in questions

A • PRACTISE — complete each one

- 1 ERROR 1 I keep saying _____ instead of _____
- 2 ERROR 2 I keep saying _____ instead of _____
- 3 ERROR 3 I keep saying _____ instead of _____
- 4 The one that appears most often is _____
- 5 It usually happens when I’m _____

B • FIND THE ERROR — one word is wrong in each

- 1 Now write five correct sentences for error 1 — on the lines in section C. _____
- 2 Then five for error 2. Say every one out loud twice. _____
- 3 Come back on Sunday and check whether they held up in real speech. _____

C • MAKE IT YOURS — three sentences about your real life

D • SAY IT WITHOUT THINKING. Cover section C. Say your three sentences out loud from memory, then say three new ones. Repeat until none of them need a pause in the middle. This is the only step that makes the grammar automatic.





Words that work

★ also on your printed page · audio for every example: chanochka.github.io/8-weeks-of-english/words.html?week=8

5 MINUTES, MONDAY · THURSDAY · SUNDAY. Monday: read every line out loud and say your own sentence for three.

Thursday: use three on purpose in your speaking day. Sunday: cover the phrases, read the meanings, retrieve them. Tick a box only when the phrase came out of your mouth in a real sentence.

Phrasal verbs

THE VERBS PEOPLE ACTUALLY USE

☐ catch up (with) ★	talk to someone you haven't seen for a while	Let's catch up over coffee next week.
☐ hang on ★	wait a moment	Hang on, let me check.
☐ strike up (a conversation) ★	start a conversation with someone new	I struck up a conversation with the woman next to me.
☐ drop by ★	visit briefly without planning	Drop by whenever you're in the area.
☐ get by (in) ★	manage with the little you have	I can get by in Spanish, but that's it.
☐ pick up ★	learn without really studying	I picked up a few phrases on holiday.
☐ hang out (with)	spend relaxed time with someone	What do you usually do when you hang out with friends?
☐ chip in	add a comment to a conversation; add money to a shared cost	Can I just chip in here?
☐ mix up	confuse two things	Sorry, I mixed up the dates.
☐ speak up	speak louder; say what you think	Could you speak up a bit? It's noisy in here.
☐ wrap up	finish	Let's wrap up — I have to run.
☐ open up	start talking about your feelings	It took him a while to open up.

Idioms

THE ONES YOU WILL REALLY HEAR

☐ break the ice ★	help people relax at the start	I told a silly joke to break the ice.
☐ on the tip of my tongue ★	I almost remember the word	What's it called... it's on the tip of my tongue.
☐ get the hang of ★	learn how to do something	I'm finally getting the hang of it.
☐ long time no see	friendly hello after a long time	Long time no see! How have you been?
☐ I'm all ears	I'm listening carefully	Go on, I'm all ears.
☐ put your foot in it	say something embarrassing by mistake	I really put my foot in it when I asked about his ex.

Words that go together

LEARN THEM AS ONE PIECE

☐ make small talk ★ I'm not great at making small talk.	☐ keep the conversation going ★ Ask questions to keep the conversation going.
☐ change the subject ★ He quickly changed the subject.	☐ have a chat ★ We had a quick chat after the meeting.
☐ keep in touch ★ Let's keep in touch!	☐ a slip of the tongue ★ Sorry, that was a slip of the tongue.
☐ an awkward silence There was an awkward silence.	☐ a quick question Can I ask you a quick question?
☐ have a word (with) Can I have a word with you?	☐ no offence, but... No offence, but I don't agree.



Questions that sound natural – indirect questions and tags

Talking to strangers is mostly questions. Indirect questions sound polite; tags keep small talk moving.

INDIRECT

Do you know / Could you tell me + where / if + normal order: Do you know where the station is?

TAGS

positive → negative tag, negative → positive: It's cold, isn't it? · You haven't been here before, have you?

TONE

falls = you expect agreement (small talk) · rises = you really don't know

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

~~Do you know where is the toilet? You're from here, no?~~

Do you know where the toilet is? You're from here, aren't you?

How it sounds in real English

- Could you tell me what time it opens?
- Nice day, isn't it?
- I was wondering if you could help me.
- You've been here before, haven't you?

WORTH KNOWING

Tricky tags: I'm right, aren't I? · Let's go, shall we? · Nobody called, did they? · Pass me the salt, would you?

A · Practise — complete each one

ANSWERS AT THE BACK, PAGE 120

- 1 Where is the nearest pharmacy? → Do you know where _____?
- 2 Does this bus go to the centre? → Could you tell me _____ this bus goes to the centre?
- 3 It's a great place, _____?
- 4 You haven't met Tom, _____?
- 5 What time does it close? → I was wondering what time _____.

B · Quick check — this week's word bank

FROM MEMORY FIRST

- 1 Sorry, _____ a second — I need to find my ticket.
- 2 I can't remember his name — it's _____.
- 3 Could you tell me where _____ (the exit / be)?
- 4 I don't speak Italian, but I can _____.
- 5 It was awkward at first, but a joke helped _____.
- 6 You've been here before, _____?

C · Say it out loud

RECORD ONE ON THURSDAY

- ☐ Strike up a conversation with a stranger (or ChatGPT Voice playing one). Use one indirect question and one tag.
- ☐ Tell the story of a time you put your foot in it.
- ☐ Explain a word that is on the tip of your tongue without saying it.



♥ TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH

- ① Sorry to bother you — do you know...?

2 Is this seat taken?

3 How's your day going?

4 Nice one, thanks.

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Say something in English to one real person today. Online counts; a comment does not.
- ☐ Before you do it, say your opening line out loud three times.
- ☐ Afterwards, write down what you actually said, mistakes included.
- ☐ Watch for your audited errors. Did either of them appear?

10-20 MIN • OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “Role-play a stranger at a bus stop. Be a bit unhelpful so I have to keep the conversation going.”
- ☐ Do it a second time with a different opening line.

The real conversation, mistakes included. Not the version you wish you had said.

LISTEN



TODAY'S GOAL Understand fast, unclear, overlapping speech with no help.

♥ **LISTEN FOR THESE — TICK EACH ONE YOU HEAR, THEN WRITE THE FULL SENTENCE**

1 Say that again?

.....

2 You've lost me.

.....

3 Ah, got it.

.....

4 No worries.

.....

WHAT TO FIND "English conversation different accents fast speech"

YouTube · mix accents on purpose: British, Irish, American, Indian, Australian · length: 12 min, fast, two accents, no subtitles available

1 listen once, no subtitles

2 never pause

3 write what you understood

4 listen again

5 catch 3-5 chunks

6 now check the transcript

7 what did you miss, and why

8 shadow 20-40 seconds

9 retell it without looking

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Steps 1-9 above, at 1.25x speed, no subtitles at any point until step 6.
- ☐ Collect 5 chunks. Log them — the last five of the whole course.
- ☐ Write what you missed and WHY: speed, accent, vocabulary, or reduced sounds.
- ☐ Shadow 40 seconds of the fastest speaker.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +1 DAY.
- ☐ Find a clip in an accent you find hardest and give it four minutes.

WHAT I MISSED, AND WHY



Speed, accent, vocabulary or reduction? Name the real reason.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....



💖 TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH

- ④ Not what I expected.

- ☐ Read something you genuinely want to read, in English. Your own interests, not a study text.
- ☐ Recommend it out loud to an imaginary friend in 30 seconds.
- ☐ Then recommend it again in 90 seconds, with a reason and an example.
- ☐ Log five chunks — only ones you would actually say.

- ☐ Write the recommendation as a real message and send it to someone.
- ☐ Read the best paragraph out loud twice.



① So what have you been up to?

② Same here, honestly.

3 Tell me more about...

④ We should do this again.

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Have one conversation with no topic agreed in advance. Fifteen minutes.
- ☐ No preparing sentences in your head while the other person talks. Listen instead.
- ☐ DRILL · REPAIR IT + PARAPHRASE. Missing word? Explain around it and keep going. Never switch language.
- ☐ Afterwards write what surprised you about how it went.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ BONUS · ChatGPT Voice: “Have a 15-minute conversation with me. Change topic whenever you like without warning me.”
- ☐ Record five minutes of it and listen back once.

What surprised you. What you could do that you could not do in week one.



① I've been... for two years.

② I did that yesterday.

③ It depends on the situation.

④ I'm used to...

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Finish the personal error audit on this week's cheat sheet if you have not yet. Evidence, not memory.
- ☐ Write five correct sentences for each of your top two errors. Real content, your life.
- ☐ Say all ten out loud twice, then cover the page and say ten new ones.
- ☐ Record 60 seconds of free speech and count whether the errors appear.

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Review · +3 DAYS.
- ☐ Ask ChatGPT Voice: “I keep making this mistake: [error]. Ask me ten questions where I would need that structure to answer.”

Five for each error. Say them out loud before you write them down.

SOUND NATURAL



TODAY'S GOAL Record yourself and compare it with day one.

♥ **SAY THESE — AND MEAN THEM, WITH REAL EXAMPLES**

1 Eight weeks ago I couldn't...

2 Now I can...

3 I still need to work on...

4 I sound more...

RECOGNISE ONLY — don't copy these

Eight weeks does not remove an accent, and it does not need to.

Intelligibility and rhythm are the goal.

Clear beats native every time.

PRACTISE SAYING — aim for this

Your own week-1 sentences, said again today.

Same words, better rhythm and clearer thought groups.

That difference is the whole point.

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Record two minutes on any topic. No preparation.
- ☐ Now play your week-one recording immediately after it.
- ☐ Write three differences you can actually hear. Not “better” — what changed.
- ☐ Pick the one rhythm feature still worth working on after this book ends.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Play both to someone else and ask what they notice.
- ☐ Record the same two minutes again, applying the one thing you just noticed.

SOUND NOTES



Three differences between then and now. Concrete, hearable, specific.

DAY 56



TODAY'S GOAL Close the eight weeks and decide what happens on Monday.

♥ **TODAY'S PHRASES — WRITE YOUR OWN VERSION UNDERNEATH**

1 Over eight weeks I...

2 The thing that worked was...

3 I'm no longer afraid to...

4 From here, my plan is...

☆ **CORE**

30-40 MIN · FINISH THESE AND THE DAY IS DONE

- ☐ Do the FINAL TEST pages before anything else. All four tasks, then the comparison table.
- ☐ Review · pull ten chunks from any week at random and retrieve them cold.
- ☐ Speak for five minutes about the whole eight weeks. No notes, no stopping.
- ☐ Sign the certificate. Then write your next eight weeks in three sentences.

BONUS

10-20 MIN · OPTIONAL, ALWAYS

- ☐ Choose the three weekly sessions you will keep: one speaking, one listening, one writing.
- ☐ Colour in the last row of the poster and put it somewhere you will keep seeing it.

WHAT HAPPENS NOW



Your next eight weeks, in three sentences. Specific days, specific tasks.

From here, my plan is...



Only phrases you actually met — in listening, reading, a conversation, or a word you wanted and could not find.
Whole chunks, not single words. Tick a review box only when you retrieved it **without looking at the page**.

HOW TO REVIEW — pick one, never just re-read

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

HOW TO REVIEW — pick one, never just re-read

Cover it and recall · finish a sentence with it · use it in a brand-new sentence · work it into a 60-second monologue · answer a question with it.

FIVE I MUST USE OUT LOUD NEXT WEEK

FIVE I MUST USE OUT LOUD NEXT WEEK

COMING BACK THIS WEEK • a sample from every week — find those pages, cover the English, and retrieve five of them out loud before Sunday.

WEEK REVIEW



DAYS I SHOWED UP — COLOUR ONE FLOWER PER DAY



MON



TUE



WED



THU



FRI



SAT



SUN

MEASURE IT — the same seven numbers every week

Longest no-stop speaking min sec Active phrases I actually used

Translating in my head ☐ constantly ☐ often ☐ sometimes ☐ rarely

Listening without subtitles % Confidence speaking 1 2 3 4 5

Grammar mistake I keep making

Hardest sound or rhythm feature

Something I said easily

.....

.....

.....

Where I got stuck

.....

.....

.....

Five things I can say now that I could not say on Monday

1

2

3

4

5

Next week I will change one thing

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

CARRY FORWARD

Copy your five phrases onto next Monday's page. If you did not use last week's five, they come with you again.



FINAL TEST — SAME FOUR TASKS

Record everything first. Do not listen to your day 1 files until all four tasks are finished — hearing the old version changes how you speak.

A • SPEAKING — 3–5 minutes, no preparation

Same question as day 1: *“Tell me about yourself, your life right now, and one thing you want to change.”* Then keep going: what changed in the last eight weeks.

I SPOKE FOR TIMES I STOPPED TIMES I USED MY OWN LANGUAGE

B • STORY — 3 minutes

Something that happened in the last month. Chronology a stranger could follow, no notes, no restarts.

I SPOKE FOR TENSES THAT HELD UP

D • LISTENING — the same kind of clip, harder

Search **“native English conversation everyday life”** again, but take a clip with two speakers talking over each other. Four minutes, no subtitles, no pausing.

I UNDERSTOOD ABOUT % WHAT STILL MAKES IT HARD

C • WRITING — 180–250 words, no translator, no AI

Same shape as day 1: your last two weeks, and what you want from the next two months. Write it on the back of this sheet or in your notebook, then bring the word count here.

WORD COUNT MINUTES IT TOOK

DAY 1 vs DAY 56

Play both recordings back to back. Fill the numbers in from your own two folders, not from memory.

	DAY 1	DAY 56
Seconds I spoke before the first real stop		
Times I stopped completely		
Times I used my own language		
Story: could a stranger follow the order of events?		
Listening: % I understood, no subtitles		
Writing: word count		
Writing: minutes it took		
Phrases from the logs I used without checking		

WEEK 1 · WEEK 4 · WEEK 8 — copy from your week reviews

Longest no-stop

Translating

Listening %

Confidence 1-5

MY THREE RECURRING GRAMMAR PROBLEMS — and whether they are gone

1

2

3

What I can hear in my own voice, day 1 against day 56

Three concrete differences. Not “better” — write what actually changed.

What happens on Monday. The habit is the asset, not the book. Pick the three days of the week that worked best for you and keep them: one speaking, one listening, one writing. Consistency is what keeps retrieval fast.





Answer key

Check only after you have said your own answer out loud. A different answer can still be right — if unsure, ask the AI prompt from page 2.

Week 01 · used to · be used to · get used to

A · GRAMMAR PLUS

1 used to play · 2 'm used to the noise · 3 getting used to working · 4 use to have · 5 used to speaking

B · QUICK CHECK

1 run out of · 2 putting off · 3 call it a day · 4 sleep in · 5 snowed under · 6 stick to

Week 02 · The passive for places and things

A · GRAMMAR PLUS

1 was built · 2 is currently being repaired · 3 is known · 4 was turned · 5 has been completely redesigned

B · QUICK CHECK

1 take after · 2 put up with · 3 a stone's throw · 4 within walking distance · 5 doing up · 6 down-to-earth

Week 03 · Verb + -ing or verb + to

A · GRAMMAR PLUS

1 working · 2 to change · 3 walk · 4 telling · 5 quitting

B · QUICK CHECK

1 talked ... into · 2 my cup of tea · 3 pointed out · 4 sitting on the fence · 5 came round · 6 a valid point / a fair point

Week 04 · Reported speech — telling what people said

A · GRAMMAR PLUS

1 was · 2 if · 3 not to · 4 I worked · 5 had

B · QUICK CHECK

1 ended up · 2 ran into · 3 a blessing in disguise · 4 lost track of time · 5 broke down · 6 out of the blue

Week 05 · Present perfect continuous — what you've been doing

A · GRAMMAR PLUS

1 've been trying · 2 have ... been working · 3 've sent · 4 Have ... been sleeping · 5 've been waiting

B · QUICK CHECK

1 fallen behind · 2 run ... by · 3 back to square one · 4 come up · 5 've been working · 6 not rocket science

Week 06 · I wish · If only

A · GRAMMAR PLUS

1 lived · 2 hadn't said · 3 would turn down · 4 could · 5 had studied ... would have

B · QUICK CHECK

1 fell through · 2 looking forward to · 3 up in the air · 4 had known · 5 a long shot · 6 weigh up

Week 07 · Emphasis — what..., the thing is..., it's... that

A · GRAMMAR PLUS

1 is · 2 is · 3 who · 4 that · 5 saying

B · QUICK CHECK

1 boils down to · 2 the elephant in the room · 3 get ... across · 4 a double-edged sword · 5 What · 6 strike

Week 08 · Questions that sound natural — indirect questions and tags

A · GRAMMAR PLUS

1 the nearest pharmacy is · 2 if / whether · 3 isn't it · 4 have you · 5 it closes

B · QUICK CHECK

1 hang on · 2 on the tip of my tongue · 3 the exit is · 4 get by · 5 break the ice · 6 haven't you

CUT ALONG THE DOTTED LINES

STICKER SHEET

Colour them in, cut them out, stick them on the days you finished. Print on thicker paper if you have it.



SPOKE OUT LOUD



LISTENED TWICE



READ IT ALL



GRAMMAR DONE



RECORDED ME



SEVEN IN A ROW



NO TRANSLATING



WEEK COMPLETE



NO PREP, STILL SPOKE



TALKED TO A HUMAN



SHOWED UP ANYWAY



NO SUBTITLES



**FINISHED THE
SENTENCE**



EXPLAINED AROUND IT



FIXED MY RHYTHM



**CAUGHT MY OWN
ERROR**

PUT THIS ON YOUR WALL

56 DAYS

One heart per day. Colour it the moment you finish speaking out loud.

MON

TUE

WED

THU

FRI

SAT

SUN

WK 01

ACTIVATE



WK 02

ACTIVATE



WK 03

EXPRESS



WK 04

EXPRESS



WK 05

THINK



WK 06

THINK



WK 07

FLUENCY



WK 08

FLUENCY



THE THREE NUMBERS WORTH WATCHING — from your week reviews

LONGEST NO-STOP SPEAKING

WK1

WK4

WK8

LISTENING WITHOUT SUBTITLES

WK1

WK4

WK8

TRANSLATING IN MY HEAD

WK1

WK4

WK8

Seven in a row? Give yourself a sticker. Showing up on the days you do not feel like it is what makes retrieval faster — consistency does more for automatic English than any single long session.





EIGHT WEEKS. FIFTY-SIX DAYS.

YOU DID IT

This is to certify that

finished all eight weeks, spoke English out loud on purpose, and stopped waiting to feel ready.



DATE

SIGNED BY ME

USE ENGLISH. DON'T JUST STUDY ENGLISH.